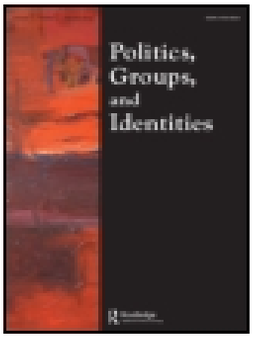

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Yes, structurally low turnout favors the right

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ABSTRACT
It is well known that socioeconomically disadvantaged citizens tend to vote less than other citizens. Does this cause democratic politics to systematically favor conservative causes? Surprisingly, the conventional wisdom in a very large scholarly literature says "no." Whether turnout is high or low, according to numerous studies, makes no substantive difference on political outcomes. This article refutes the scholarly conventional wisdom on theoretical and empirical grounds. It points out that the evidence marshaled in the mainstream turnout debate focuses almost exclusively on partisan vote shares as the dependent variable and "nonstructural" variation in turnout. Unfortunately, many studies do not consider the *policy* consequences of turnout, a more substantively interesting variable for studying patterns of disadvantage that may result from unequal voting rates. Moreover, conventional research designs do not distinguish between *structural* changes in turnout caused by legal changes to the voting regime and *nonstructural* changes precipitated by partisan mobilization, candidate valence, or other election-specific factors. This distinction has substantial implications for understanding turnout's impact. The article employs nonparametric meta-analytic methods to synthesize a large number of empirical studies and demonstrates that low structural turnout does indeed favor the right in theoretically predictable ways.

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Introduction

One might expect that higher voter turnout should benefit the candidates and policies of the left, while lower turnout benefits the right. Indeed, this view is widely held by political candidates, pundits, and consultants (cf., Nagel and McNulty 1996). The logic underlying this popular notion is simple: because nonvoters are more likely to be poor or working class, less educated, and belong to a minority group, political outcomes would change if they voted, and change in ways that would benefit leftist causes (Merriam and Gosnell 1923; Tingsten 1937; Burnham 1987; Lijphart 1997).[1] This argument seems straightforward, and obviously important for those interested in questions dealing with structural disadvantage in democratic polities.

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Surprisingly, however, most empirical studies conclude that this argument is wrong. Highton and Wolfinger (2001, 179), for instance, contend "[s]imply put, outcomes would not change if everyone voted;" and they are not alone. In fact, studies concluding low turnout has no consequential effect on political outcomes are so numerous that Lutz and Marsh (2007, 544), in a recent symposium on the topic, summarize the literature as follows:

> [t]he various articles, despite using different approaches, looking at different countries and different types of election, all show that any bias in election outcomes is typically rather small and it is not in a specific direction: sometimes the left would benefit from higher turnout, sometimes other parties.

The authors conclude therefore that, "the concerns about potential bias consequent on low turnout are generally misplaced" (539).

This article argues that the scholarly conventional wisdom is incorrect. Turnout does indeed matter, and it matters specifically because it affects the kinds of policies that elected officials pursue. To demonstrate this, the paper utilizes a standard spatial model of electoral competition to develop straightforward theoretical propositions about precisely when and how voter turnout matters, and it uses the tools of meta-analysis to show that these arguments are consistent with the preponderance of empirical evidence.

To delineate the claims advanced in this article it is necessary to impose some structure from the outset. When a scholar or pundit asserts that "higher turnout would benefit the left," one must ask, "What factors precipitated the change in turnout?" "How much more turnout are we talking about?" and "In what sense is the left benefited?"

Consider the first question: "What factors precipitated the change in turnout?" One possible answer is that turnout changed because the net structural incentives to participate in elections changed. By "structural incentives" to participate I simply mean those sourced in law. Structural incentives can be negative – for example, when citizens must pay poll taxes to vote, or are legally barred from voting on the basis of their gender – or positive – for example, when voting is compulsory. Another possible answer is that turnout changed for a "nonstructural" reason – such as when one party mounts a large mobilization effort. While one might expect a structural increase in turnout to benefit the left (under certain circumstances), it is hard to see why an increase in turnout generated by mobilization campaigns by the right should do so.

Now consider the second question: How large a counterfactual change are we entertaining? Are we imagining relatively marginal changes, say, of the order one would expect were the Democrats to spend an additional hundred thousand dollars mobilizing voters in New York City? Or, much larger variation, say, of the order we would expect if strict compulsory voting implemented in the USA or in all of Switzerland's cantons? Obviously, small increases in participation may have little impact, whereas larger increases may have profound political implications.

Consider finally the third question: "In what sense might the left benefit when turnout is increased?" Scholars have implicitly answered this question in one of two ways. When Kousser (1980), for example, argues that the low turnout induced by the emergence of Jim Crow voting restrictions hurt African-Americans in turn-of-the-century North Carolina, he is referring to educational expenditure per pupil – a specific policy outcome. On the other hand, when Citrin, Schickler, and Sides (2003, 83) claim that only "four of the 91

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races [in the 1994, 1996, and 1998 US Senate elections] would have had a different winner if everyone eligible had voted," they are referring to who wins – an electoral outcome. There are thus at least two meaningful senses in which the left may succeed or not, so deciding whether or not the Left "did well in Election X" depends on whether the dependent variable of interest is the number of votes the Left picked up, or the policies subsequently enacted by elected officials.

This article attempts to discern turnout's implications for both electoral and policy outcomes. It makes a series of central claims, relevant for polities in which politics is basically "spatial" and not too "distributive." Spatial politics refers to public policy decisions whose outcomes affect all members of society, as in the uniform tax rate model developed by Meltzer and Richard (1981). Distributive policy in contrast refers to the allocation of private goods that are excludable and can be targeted to individuals, geographic areas, specific industries or firms, etc. The paper's central claims are these:

(1) Nonstructural increases in turnout should not systematically boost the Left's vote share.
(2) Nonstructural increases in turnout should not systematically move policy leftward.
(3) Structural increases in turnout should not theoretically, nor do they empirically, boost the Left's vote share.
(4) Structural increases in turnout should theoretically, and do empirically, move policy leftward.

With a few important qualifications, the literature provides strong support for these propositions.

The paper is organized as follows. The next section lays out the theoretical arguments underlying the conventional wisdom that turnout "doesn't matter," and the counterarguments suggesting that it does. Next, I derive two key predictions from a spatial model of electoral competition. The most important prediction is that turnout "matters" because it affects equilibrium *policy*, a theoretical point that is remarkably difficult to find in the scholarly turnout debate. The paper subsequently describes the meta-analytic methods used to test the theoretical assertions and presents the results of the analysis. The final section summarizes the important conclusions.

Arguments and counterarguments regarding turnout's consequentiality

This section describes the claims on both sides of the turnout debate, beginning with the conventional wisdom suggesting low turnout is not a cause for normative concern. It goes on to make the case that the conventional arguments overlook several theoretical points suggesting that turnout does indeed "matter." Sustained structural turnout matters because it affects policy, not vote shares.

The conventional wisdom that turnout "doesn't matter"

Scholarly conventional wisdom that turnout levels are inconsequential is based on two types of argument. One is theoretical, the other empirical. The theoretical argument contends that nonvoters would not choose any differently than voters if they were to

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participate in elections, so nonvoters are well represented policy-wise (if not descriptively). The empirical argument that turnout does not matter is based on direct observation of the correlation between turnout and partisan vote shares: overwhelmingly, such observations find that turnout levels and leftist vote shares are *not* correlated.

In many ways the turnout debate began with Wolfinger and Rosenstone (1980), who first made the semi-normative argument that low turnout "doesn't matter." Wolfinger and Rosentsone's seminal study framed the terms of the subsequent debate by introducing a popular research design and documenting several robust empirical patterns. Specifically, the authors' analysis of the US electorate found that regular voters were disproportionately white, well-educated, financially well-off, married, Northerners, government employees, and residentially stable. Wolfinger and Rosenstone thus documented the well-corroborated empirical regularity that the disadvantaged are underrepresented at the polls.

Despite their resounding finding, WR's analysis of the 1972 National Election Survey nevertheless led them to conclude that, with respect to most important political issues,

> voters are virtually a carbon copy of the citizen population. Those most likely to be underrepresented are people who lack opinions … as long as attitudes on issues are so weakly related to social class and race, the poor and minorities will find enough allies to avoid political weakness in proportion to their own voting rates. (109–111)

One can adduce numerous subsequent studies that reach a similar conclusion (e.g., Bennet and Resnick 1990; Teixeira 1992; Gant and Lyons 1993; Highton and Wolfinger 2001). Indeed, Ellcessor and Leighly (2001, 127) write that "one of the least contested conclusions in the study of [US] political behavior is that voters' political attitudes and policy positions are fairly representative of non-voters." Countries other than the USA have received less attention regarding the ideological similarity of voters and nonvoters, but scholars who have looked overwhelmingly agree that Wolfinger and Rosenstone's basic conclusions are generally valid elsewhere – see, for example, Highton (2004); Studlar and Welch (1986, 139) and Tóka (2004, 47).

Most of the authors cited above, like Wolfinger and Rosentone, have taken their findings as evidence that low turnout is not cause for normative concern because the results seem to imply that the distribution of preferences among those casting ballots would be the same regardless of who cast the ballots. It is worth noting that this particular "turnout doesn't matter" argument is implicitly predicated on a counterfactual of the following form: "Suppose turnout was increased by selecting non-voters *at random* and sending them to the polls, then *in expectation* the outcome of the election would not change." On the other hand, as noted above, strategic mobilization by a party with a particular ideological orientation would presumably have nonneutral consequences.

There are other arguments, less contingent on the similarity of voters' and nonvoters' preferences, which reach similar conclusions about the irrelevance of low turnout. The logic underlying such arguments, in Highton's (2001, 16,332) words, runs as follows:

> if the number of nonvoters in an election is small compared to the number of voters, then even if nonvoters have a very different set of preferences, their small number will limit the potential for impact on the aggregate preferences of voters.

Citrin, Schickler and Sides (2003; henceforth CSS) provide one well-cited example in this vein. CSS estimate an individual-level vote choice model for US Senate races using

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demographic data on voters surveyed in exit polls, then utilize their model to predict vote shares under various counterfactual turnout scenarios. CSS conclude that, while randomly bringing nonvoters to the polls would generally have boosted Democratic vote shares, very few elections were actually close enough for even large turnout increases to have changed the winner. Using a similar approach, Brunell and DiNardo (2004) conclude that of the 13 presidential elections held between 1952 and 2000, 100% turnout rates would not have made a difference in the outcome of a single election.[2]

The second type of argument that high turnout does not benefit the left is based on observational studies of partisan vote shares. The preponderance of evidence here suggests that the correlation between turnout levels and leftist vote shares is negligible. Regarding US elections, evidence of this kind is found in Key (1958), Burnham (1965), DeNardo (1980), Erikson (1995), and Nagel and McNulty (1996), for example. Scholars studying elections elsewhere reach similar conclusions. Berlinski and Dewan (2011), for instance, find no effect on partisan vote shares in the UK even after the Second Reform Act (1867) roughly doubled the British electorate.

A crucial point to make here is that all of the turnout/vote shares studies described above (and many others) are merely correlational. These correlational studies fail to consider the strategic environment in which the turnout/vote share data are generated, however, which potentially raises significant statistical identification problems. Hansford and Gomez (2010) make this point by suggesting that "policy mobilized" turnout induces endogeniety in the vote shares-turnout relationship and may therefore bias the estimates of turnout's impact on vote shares.

In the next section, I point out another strategic consideration that leads to a more fundamental critique of the conventional evidence. Specifically, standard spatial models of electoral competition suggest that *policy* (but not equilibrium vote shares!) should change in response to sustained turnout changes because strategic parties will tailor their policies to the electorate. This logic suggests that observational studies of turnout and leftist vote shares should show little correlation, even if turnout "matters" in a substantively meaningful way.

The case that turnout matters

In previous work, the standard argument that high turnout should favor the left electorally assumes that (1) the disadvantaged are underrepresented at the polls and (2) the disadvantaged have partisan preferences that differ markedly from voters'. For many scholars, these two assumptions lead naturally to the conclusion that higher voter turnout favors leftist causes.

As noted above, premise (1) of this argument – that the disadvantaged are less likely to vote – is a widely reported empirical regularity. In the USA for instance, one can adduce numerous studies documenting low participation rates among the poor, less educated, and members of most racial and ethnic minority groups (e.g., Verba and Nie 1972; Rosenstone and Hansen 1993; Verba, Schlozman, and Brady 1995; Macedo et al. 2005). That Wolfinger and Rosenstone and numerous others seem to have disproved premise (2) – by presenting survey evidence suggesting that nonvoters and voters have similar preferences – is not viewed as a death knell for those inclined to believe that the left's vote share would increase if more citizens consistently voted.

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Indeed, the ubiquitious finding that voters and nonvoters express similar preferences is countered by an argument that says: "The debate over whether or not non-voters' preferences are the same as voters' is misleading because non-voters don't have well-developed preferences in the same sense that voters do." This line of thought is found, for instance, in Lijphart's (1997, 4) presidential address to the American Political Science Association:

> Nonvoters who are asked their opinions on policy and partisan preferences in surveys are typically citizens who have not given these questions much thought, who have not been politically mobilized, and who, in terms of social class, have not developed class consciousness. It is highly likely that, if they were mobilized to vote, their votes would be quite different from their responses in opinion polls.

Three remarks are in order here. The first is that Lijphart's argument that citizens' preferences are malleable and may be influenced by the activities of parties is well founded (cf., Rosenstone and Hansen 1993). Wellhofer (1981), for instance, notes that in the context of franchise extensions in Argentina and Western Europe, Socialist-Labor parties played an important role in organizing and politicizing the newly enfranchised.[3] The second point is that, if Lijphart is imagining that leftist vote shares would rise following an increase in turnout, there is a compelling theoretical argument he is wrong. I explain this momentarily.

Third, Lijphart is implicitly making an important conceptual distinction that has not been explicit in the turnout debate, regarding the different types of variation in turnout. In his story, Lijphart seems to have in mind a counterfactual scenario involving what I will refer to as a *structural change* in turnout – that is, large sustained turnout changes caused by legal changes to the electoral process. Examples of structural turnout changes include the extension of the franchise to women or ethnic minorities or repealing impediments to voting, like the removal of poll taxes, or (as an example of a smaller change) implementing a Motor-Voter program or an election day registration protocol.

I distinguish structural turnout changes from "nonstructural" turnout fluctuations that occur for any reason that does not involve a change in the law. Nonstructural changes might take place, for example, when parties rally their bases in swing states or when the weather is particularly pleasant on Election Day. As I discuss momentarily, the structural/nonstructural distinction has potentially important theoretical consequences that have not been previously recognized.

A second rejoinder to the claim that "turnout doesn't matter" focuses on the policy implications of structural turnout, rather than partisan vote shares. Piven and Cloward (1988, 39) for instance argue the following:

> [T]he opinions elicited by surveys reflect the underdevelopment of political attitudes resulting from the historic exclusion of low-income groups from active political participation. In other words, what survey data cannot reveal is the dynamic dimension of politics. Political attitudes would inevitably change over time *if the allegiance of voters from the bottom became the object of partisan competition*, for *then politicians would be prodded to identify and articulate the grievances and aspirations of lower-income voters in order to win their support*, thus helping to give form and voice to a distinctive class politics. (Italics added.)

In this quotation the authors echo Lijphart's argument that structural increases in turnout would incentivize political parties to acculturate or politicize the previously

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underrepresented. The authors also suggest a distinct proposition: parties would adopt new policies in response to sustained turnout changes.

Although Piven and Cloward do not refer to it, the classic Downsian (1957) model provides a natural way to think about their policy claim (in fact this is how the economics literature typically discusses the implications of turnout). If politics is reasonably approximated as competition along a single policy dimension – representing, for instance, the progressivity of the tax code – the Downsian model predicts that the equilibrium policies of party Left and party Right will converge at the most preferred policy of the median voter. A logical extension of the model suggests that when higher turnout is expected to increase the relative number of voters with ideal points to the left (respectively, right) of the current median, the equilibrium policies of both parties will shift left (respectively, right).

Real world redistributive policies are typically far more complex than the unidimensional spatial model; they generally involve an assortment of tax and transfer programs whose benefits vary non-monotonically across the income scale.[4] Nevertheless, in many cases, it is not unreasonable to think of the redistributive consequences of structural turnout in terms of a simple spatial model.

Here we will focus on the well-known Downsian model developed by Romer (1975), Roberts (1977), and Meltzer and Richard (1981). In particular, assume that redistribution is achieved by applying a flat tax rate to all income and redistributing the resultant revenue as an equal lump sum payment to everyone in society. This simple model implies that the candidates' policy space is unidimensional: it equals the tax rate space [0,1]. From the first order condition of the candidate's maximization problem it is straightforward to demonstrate that a relatively poorer median leads to a political equilibrium with higher taxes and more redistribution.[5] The following is a general statement of the standard result regarding the impact of structural turnout.

PROPOSITION 1 (*Romer-Roberts-Meltzer–Richard*) *Sustained increases in turnout rates among the relatively poor should raise the equilibrium amount of government redistribution (and the tax rate) because it widens the gap between the income of the median voter and the mean income.*

Proposition 1 provides a useful benchmark result for a simple tax and transfer technology and a direct theoretical rebuttal to the claim that turnout does not matter.

How general is the prediction? The result applies most clearly to structural rather nonstructural increases in turnout because parties will not generally have the wherewithal or incentive to respond to ephemeral fluctuations in turnout. The basic prediction also obtains across a broad class of similar spatial models, including models wherein equilibrium redistribution is limited by deadweight loss from taxation (e.g., Bolton and Roland 1997), and it also obtains (weakly) in a distributive model à la Cox and McCubbins (1986) and Dixit and Londregan (1995).[6]

There is a second important implication of the spatial model that has not been pointed out in the turnout debate but bears directly on the ubiquitous evidence proffered there. Notice that in a Downsian equilibrium both candidates locate at the expected median and all voters are indifferent between them. The spatial model is thus consistent with survey evidence that voters and nonvoters look similar in terms of their preferred candidate (because parties' policies are not very different in equilibrium).

Significantly, the spatial model also suggests that if changes in turnout are sizable, well publicized, and sustained, strategic parties would respond by repositioning to the new

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median. It follows that structural changes in turnout should be fully anticipated by parties, and thus a regression of the left's vote share on turnout – as utilized by DeNardo (1980), Nagel and McNulty (1996), and many others – is useless for assessing the impact of structural changes. This logic underlies the second key proposition.

PROPOSITION 2 *To the extent that candidates' policy platforms track the location of the median voter, turnout levels will not be correlated with partisan vote shares.*

Proposition 2 also applies most clearly to structural turnout because it is more likely than nonstructural turnout to influence partisan platforms. Not only does Proposition 2 potentially explain the ubiquitous zero-correlational turnout/vote share results, it also conflicts with Lijphart's prediction (quoted above) that increasing turnout would increase leftist vote shares. Proposition 2's conclusion is valid for two-party systems where politics is basically unidimensional; but the general logic is likely to carry over to multiparty systems as well, to the extent that parties' policies re-equilibrate following structural changes in turnout.

Summary of testable implications

The preceding section developed theoretical arguments that counter the conventional theory and evidence that turnout levels are politically inconsequential. I will test the theory's two key implications below using a systematic review of published empirical studies and nonparametric meta-analytic methods (discussed momentarily). This section summarizes the testable implications of the theory.

Our theoretical claims focus on two kinds of dependent variables: (1) the vote share of leftist parties and (2) policy outcomes. The "treatment" variable of interest is the level of voter turnout, of which our theory distinguishes between two kinds: (a) structural and (b) nonstructural. These distinctions imply four conceptual relationships – one for each pair

Table 1. Summary of theoretical implications to be tested and meta-analytic search results.

	Dependent variable is policy liberalism/conservatism	Dependent variable is partisan vote shares
Independent variable is structural change in turnout	*I.* *Hypothesis*: Assuming the turnout change leads to a sustained leftward shift of the electorate, policy should shift left $N = 31$ 77.4% find a positive effect ($N = 24$) 3.2% find a negative effect ($N = 1$) 19.4% find zero effect ($N = 6$)	*II.* *Hypothesis*: Parties should anticipate the change in turnout and update their policies accordingly. There should be no change in Left's vote share, per the spatial model $N = 12$ 17.7% find a positive effect ($N = 2$) 0% find a negative effect ($N = 0$) 83.3% find zero effect ($N = 10$)
Independent variable is nonstructural change in turnout	*III.* *Hypothesis*: Ambiguous. To the extent that turnout change is unexpected or expected to be temporary, it should not lead to a leftward policy shift $N = 5$ 60% find a positive effect ($N = 3$) 0% find a negative effect ($N = 0$) 40% find zero effect ($N = 2$)	*IV.* *Hypothesis*: Ambiguous. Depends on the reason for the nonstructural turnout change. Mobilization campaigns should benefit the party that launched them. Neutral turnout shocks should be uncorrelated with vote shares $N = 26$ 34.6% find a positive effect ($N = 9$) 6.3% find a negative effect ($N = 1$) 61.5% find zero effect ($N = 16$)

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of dependent and independent variables. These relationships are depicted in Table 1, along with the corresponding hypotheses and the number of studies identified in each subsample (discussed momentarily).

The two relationships dealing with *structural* turnout variation (corresponding to Cells I and II) most clearly fall within the purview of Propositions 1 and 2. It is these relationships I examine to test my arguments. In general, we only expect to find a significant statistical relationship between structural turnout and policy outcomes. Per Proposition 1, higher structural turnout that incorporates lower socioeconomic groups should lead to more liberal policies. In contrast, per Proposition 2, we hypothesize that there should be no systematic relationship between structural turnout and partisan vote shares because parties should tailor their policies to the structural turnout regime and thus preserve status quo ante vote shares.

Variation in turnout precipitated by nonstructural factors is less apt to satisfy the premises of Propositions 1 and 2, hence the relationships corresponding to Cells III and IV do not provide strong tests of these claims. Nevertheless, we have no obvious reason to expect a systematic relationship between nonstructural turnout and policy outcomes and, with a significant caveat, we might also expect to find no systematic relationship between nonstructural turnout and partisan vote shares. The caveat is that nonneutral turnout changes that disproportionately increase voting among partisans may affect vote shares, because parties will not necessarily accommodate short-lived fluctuations by changing their policies.

Data and methods

This study uses nonparametric meta-analysis to assess the two key theoretical predictions described in the preceding section. Meta-analysis is a collection of techniques for pooling multiple empirical studies into a single data set and utilizing statistical and other methods to explain the variance across the findings. Meta-analysis is employed extensively in the physical and biological sciences and its use is increasing in political science (see e.g., Imbeau, Pétry, and Lamari 2001; Roscoe and Jenkins 2005; Geys 2006; Lau, Sigelman, and Rovner. 2007). Studies pertaining to each of the four relationships in Table 1 were identified using a systematic keyword search (in English) of the major research databases, including Google Scholar, JSTOR, Worldwide Political Science Abstracts, EconLit, and Web of Science. "Backward mapping," that is, searching the references in identified studies, was then used to identify other relevant research (cf., Roscoe and Jenkins 2005).

A general concern in meta-analytic studies regards publication bias, because insignificant results are less likely to be positively reviewed. Including unpublished studies is one approach to mitigate this problem but it risks incorporating less reliable results. Though it comes at some potential cost, we will focus on published research here on the assumption this will provide a higher level of quality control.[7] To the extent that publication bias is present it will presumably bias our results in favor of confirming our prediction of a positive structural turnout/policy relationship and work against our prediction that the other relationships should be statistically insignificant (more on which follows).

The relevant literature contains a very diverse set of observational studies with dramatic differences in methodology and operationalization of the variables that necessitates a

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flexible meta-analytic technique and some subjective judgment. Three coding decisions in particular are worth highlighting.

First, there is naturally some ambiguity about what constitutes a "leftward" policy or vote share. This study attempted to remain agnostic on this matter. Regarding partisan vote shares, I relied on the coding decision of the authors of the various studies as to which parties represented the "left." Regarding policy, the analysis simply sought to determine whether the study in question concluded that voting advantaged those who turned out, or disadvantaged those who did not.

Second, several studies examining topics of clear relevance were omitted from the meta-analysis because the dependent or independent variable did not strictly fall under the purview of the theory. For example, Hajnal and Jessica's (2005) study of minority turnout in local elections was omitted because the outcome variable was the racial composition of local representative bodies, not policy or partisan vote shares per se. Likewise, several cross-national studies examining the relationship between "democracy" and redistribution were omitted because the dependent variable was an index of democratization such as the country's Polity score, not voter turnout (e.g., Acemoglu and Robinson 2000; Boix 2003).

Finally, in studies analyzing time-series cross-sectional data across units with different electoral laws, the variation in turnout presumably derives from both structural sources (across units) and nonstructural sources (within units over time). The rubric for deciding whether the variation was chiefly structural or not was based on whether the study employed unit fixed effects. If it did, the presumption was that the turnout variation was predominately nonstructural. The online appendix describes the coding protocol in greater detail and comments on the individual coding decisions.

There is a growing methodological literature that aims to develop meta-analytic methods of computing average effect sizes across studies (Hunter and Schmidt 2004). Naturally, such techniques are most easily implemented in fields that use a similar set of quantifiable variables and similar statistical research designs. The types of studies aggregated here are extremely heterogeneous, however, so the present study employs relatively simple techniques.

Specifically, following Geys (2006) and Imbeau, Pétry, and Lamari (2001), I utilize one of the most basic nonparametric meta-analytic procedures known as "vote counting," which simply compares the number of studies that are consistent with the hypothesis versus the number that are not. Vote counting is considered a valid approach when the sample studies are so different that they cannot be combined statistically, but are sufficiently similar that the direction of the effect is meaningful (Wolf 1986).

To conduct statistical tests of our hypotheses I utilize a conservative version of the binomial sign-test based on the number of studies whose outcome is consistent with our theoretical predictions. Under the null hypothesis that the theory has a 50–50 chance of correctly predicting the conclusion of any one study, in expectation, the number of "successes" should equal the number of "failures." My approach tallies the number of successful predictions observed in the sample and utilizes the binomial distribution to determine if the number of successes occurs more frequently than chance would suggest. In other words, the p-value of the observed outcome is determined with reference to a binomial distribution with N "trials" (i.e., independent studies) where the probability of success in each trial equals 0.5 (Hunter and Schmidt 2004, 449).[8]

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Results

Table 1 summarizes the data collection results and Table 2 reports the results of the empirical tests. The search turned up 74 studies, with a majority appearing in Cells I and IV. Space constraints prevent me from including in the references each of the studies in the meta-analysis, but every study in the sample (and several related works) are cited in full in the supplemental information, along with the article abstracts and discussion of the coding decisions. The findings of the analysis are summarized here.

Overall, the evidence provides compelling support for the two key theoretical claims. In particular, if one looks at the quasi-experimental evidence regarding the impact of structural turnout on policy outcomes, most of it supports the thesis that turnout "matters" because it affects policy. Moreover, there is strong statistical evidence that structural turnout levels are uncorrelated with party vote shares, precisely as a simple spatial model predicts.

Beginning with Cell I, of the 31 studies identified in this category, 77.4% ($N = 24$) support the prediction that policy benefits accrue to groups with higher structural turnout rates. As Table 2 indicates, this support is significant at the 1% confidence level: the probability of observing 24 or more successes out of 31 trials is less than 0.003 under the null hypothesis that successes and failures are equally likely.[9]

In Cell I, historical franchise extensions provided a particularly useful source of quasi-experimental data for testing the policy implications of structural turnout. For example, there is a remarkably consistent finding that female suffrage had a significant effect on various public expenditures. In the USA, for instance, Miller (2008, 1287) finds that the 19th Amendment and previous state female suffrage laws precipitated "immediate shifts in legislative behavior and large, sudden increases in local public health spending" leading to large-scale hygiene campaigns that reduced child mortality by a remarkable 8–15% per annum (20,000 averted child deaths per year).

Lott and Kenny (1999) report complementary findings suggesting female suffrage produced immediate increases in state-level tax-and-spending policy and a liberalizing effect on states' congressional representatives (as measured by their DW-NOMINATE scores). Cross-nationally, Aidt and Dallal (2008) conclude female suffrage increased average social spending as a fraction of GDP by 0.6–1.2% points in the short-run and three to eight times more in the long run. Abrams and Settle (1999) find that the extension of the franchise to women in Switzerland in 1971 increased social welfare spending by 28%.

Table 2. Results of meta-analysis.

Relationship of interest (Corresponding cell in Table 1)	Studies *N*	Successful predictions	Failed predictions	Prediction success rate (%)	Binomial sign-test *p*-value
Structural turnout/policy (Cell I)	31	24	7	77.4	0.003**
Structural turnout/vote shares (Cell II)	12	10	2	83.3	0.039*
Nonstructural turnout/policy[a] (Cell III)	5	2	3	40	1.00
Nonstructural turnout/vote shares[a] (Cell IV)	26	16	10	61.5	0.327

Note: Significance levels based on two-tailed tests.
*Statistically significant support in favor of the hypothesis at the 5% level.
**Significance at the 1% level.
[a]The prediction tested here is that nonstructural turnout levels have no effect, but the theoretical prediction is not clear-cut in this case, per the discussion in the text.

Another common research topic is the effect of historical enfranchisements of lower economic strata. Here again the preponderance of the evidence supports the "turnout matters" thesis, though there are some apparent differences on the tax and expenditure sides of governments' balance sheets that have not been explained (or widely recognized).

Concerning expenditures, there is a "growing consensus that the extension of the franchise contributed positively to the growth in government" (Aidt and Peter 2009, 379). For example, Lindert's (2004) widely cited study identifies the growth of the electorate as one of the key factors explaining the dramatic rise in social spending, poor relief, and public education in the developed world since 1880. Lizzeri and Persico (2004) find that England's nineteenth-century Reform Acts increased the share of redistribution toward urban expenditures (if not the total amount of national redistribution) in favor of Britain's lower classes.

Two other representative studies, by Aidt, Dutta, and Loukoianova (2006) and Aidt and Peter (2009), find structural turnout increases enlarged the public sector in a dozen western democracies between the middle nineteenth century and World War II. In Australia, Fowler (2013) estimates that the introduction of compulsory voting in the first half of the twentieth century precipitated a 40% increase in federal pensions.

On the tax side, for reasons that have not been fully explained, scholars find that the structural turnout regime has generally had a smaller impact on policy outcomes. For instance, Scheve and Stasavage (2012), show that tax rates were constant during the late nineteenth and early twentieth century – despite significant franchising episodes during these decades – and rose appreciably only when countries mobilized for war. Aidt and Peter (2009) find a non-monotonic relationship between franchise extension and the probability of adopting income tax and Timmons' (2010) analysis of panel data for over 100 countries from 1970 to 1999 finds that higher turnout increased tax revenue, but mostly by increasing regressive taxation. These three studies account for almost half the failed predictions in Cell I.

The USA has been the subject of numerous relevant studies examining the impact of three large enfranchising events that dominate the national historical landscape: the enfranchisement of African-American males following the 15th Amendment, the enfranchisement of women following the 19th Amendment and the effective reenfranchisement of blacks in the South after the Voting Rights Act (1965).

Similar to the 19th Amendment, the 15th Amendment is widely viewed as having produced positive policy outcomes for newly enfranchised voters. Between the 15th Amendment and Jim Crow, blacks voted in large numbers in the South and generally reaped the corresponding "Downsian" benefits (e.g., Woodward 1955, chapter 2). In North Carolina, for instance, Kousser (1980) shows that African-American voting in Black Belt counties produced positive "balance of payments" for blacks in educational and tax policies in the 1880s, which quickly turned negative when blacks were disfranchised.

The consequences of black *reenfranchisement* in the twentieth century South are somewhat more ambiguous. Most quantitative studies in our dataset conclude that blacks benefited policy-wise from reenfranchisement – see, for example, Keech (1968), Husted and Kenny (1997), and Cascio and Washington (2014). There are however some dissenting views, found largely in non-quantitative studies that do not fit within the parameters of the search (see, e.g., Fairclough 1990, 997). One of the few quantitative studies that looks directly at the impact of black voting and finds evidence of counterintuitive reactionary policy outcomes is Radcliff and Saiz's (1995) analysis of state budgets. This study suggests

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that increases in minority turnout relative to white turnout have actually been associated with "white backlash" and *less* spending on minority-preferred outcomes in the post-VRA era.

Summarily, despite some conflicting cases, the preponderance of the evidence in Cell I provides very strong support for the "turnout matters" thesis.

The second important test pertains to Cell II, which contains studies bearing on Proposition 2 and the effect of structural turnout on partisan vote shares. Per a Downsian-type model, one should not expect to see dramatic changes in party vote shares following structural turnout changes, if parties re-optimize accordingly. The evidence here is more sparse ($N = 12$) but it is highly consistent with the prediction of the spatial model. Ten out of twelve studies support the thesis (two-tailed $p = .039$).

Indeed, Berlinski and Dewan (2011) remarkably find that Britain's Second Reform Act (1867), which roughly doubled the electorate, had no discernable effect on the Liberal vote share. Larcinese (2011) explores a similarly large franchise extension in Italy following the introduction of "quasi-universal" male suffrage, which expanded the Italian electorate from 3 million to 8.7 million persons. He finds a negligible effect on the vote share of leftist parties, too small to change partisan seat shares in the national legislature. Fowler's (2013) finding that compulsory voting in Australia increased Labor's vote share 7–10% and Uggen and Manza's (2002) conclusion that felon disfranchisement affected the outcome of US Senate elections are the two anomalies in this cell, though the latter is called into question by Burch's (2012) analysis.

Cells III and IV are not obviously covered by Propositions 1 and 2 because they pertain to nonstructural turnout, thus, the predictions here are more ambiguous. Cell III contains studies examining the effect of nonstructural turnout variation on policy outcomes. Of the five observations in this cell, two found zero effect and three found a turnout/policy correlation.

Mueller and Stratmann's (2003) cross-national analysis concludes that voter participation did not have a significant effect on state transfers or educational expenditures among a majority of the countries in their sample. Similarly, Beck and Katz's (1995, 643) re-analysis of the dataset collected by Hicks and Swank (1992) found turnout had a (marginally) insignificant effect on national welfare effort. Other studies in cell III do find a positive turnout effect including Larcinese's (2007) cross-national study of social expenditures; Ringquist et al.'s (1997) study of welfare expenditures across US states; and Martin's (2003) study documenting a positive correlation between US counties' turnout and their share of targetable federal funds within their congressional district.

Regarding Cell IV, the theoretical prediction here is uncertain because nonstructural turnout changes could be sourced in factors that favor the left or the right. Nevertheless, a clear majority (61.5%) find no significant correlation between nonstructural turnout levels and partisan vote shares. This is not statistically significant but it is consistent with the theoretical prediction regarding *structural* turnout and vote shares and is all the more surprising given the likely publication bias against insignificant findings.

Conclusion

Following Wolfinger and Rosentone's (1980) seminal study, a large and influential literature has consistently made two arguments suggesting that low voter turnout "doesn't matter," despite the fact low turnout typically means the disadvantaged are less likely to

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have voted. The first piece of evidence marshaled in support of this quasi-normative conclusion is that nonvoters are much like voters in terms of their stated preferences, if not their demographics. Thus, as the argument goes, nonvoters are well represented policy-wise. This argument has been called "one of the least contested conclusions in the study of political behavior" (Ellcessor and Leighly 2001, 127).

I noted, however, that the theoretical relevance of this ubiquitous empirical finding has been fundamentally questioned by scholars who contend that it is misleading to take such survey evidence at face value because nonvoters are less likely to have well-developed political views (e.g., Piven and Cloward 1988; Lijphart 1997). Recent work by Leighly and Nagler (2013) has also called into question the underlying premise that nonvoters and voters express similar preferences (in the USA).

The second argument that turnout "doesn't matter" is based on the well-documented fact that turnout rates show very little correlation with the vote shares of leftist parties. The present article focused on rebutting this second argument. It did so using two key insights from a spatial model of electoral competition and nonparametric meta-analytic tests.

First, a spatial model predicts that sustained turnout changes that increase participation rates among the disadvantaged will shift equilibrium policy left once the new voters are politicized. This is significant because, from a welfare perspective, it is almost certainly the case that the policy consequences of turnout, not the distribution of partisan vote shares per se, are what substantively matter for patterns of inequality. This argument is surprisingly absent in the turnout debate that followed Wolfinger and Rosenstone's (1980) seminal study (though it's implicit in much of the economics literature).

A second, more novel observation from the spatial model is that the correlation between turnout and partisan votes shares should be zero once parties re-optimize their policies following structural turnout changes. This overlooked point potentially explains the bedrock "zero-correlation" finding in the literature, which has been a persistent puzzle for scholars despite (or perhaps because of) its pervasiveness (e.g., Nagel and McNulty 1996).

In support of its two main theoretical arguments, the paper used meta-analytic techniques to systematically classify existing empirical studies. The analysis reinforces the casual perception that most studies find no correlation between turnout and leftist vote shares and suggests that structural turnout rates *do* affect policy outcomes. In particular, most of the quasi-experimental data from large structural turnout changes, including the enfranchisement of women around the world, or the working class in Western Europe, led to more expansive social spending, poor relief and public education. In this very important sense, structurally low turnout does in fact favor the right, while higher turnout favors the right.

Going forward, one would like to know why some cases fail to conform to the theory that groups with structurally higher turnout should benefit. Brady (2003), for example, suggests that institutions mediate democratic responsiveness. The ostensibly conservative policy response to black reenfranchisment in the post-VRA suggests that racial polarity is another important mediating factor that deserves further analysis.

Notes

1. Mills (1956) and Schattschneider (1970) offer similar contentions.

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2. Similarly, Rubenson et al. (2007, 1), Tóka and Popescu (2007, 67), and Lutz (2007) all find a negligible turnout bias.
3. Conversely, the absence of political organization among the masses in seventeenth century England prevented radical change post-enfranchisement (Hirst 2005).
4. The Downsian model also assumes exactly two candidates.
5. See, for example, Meltzer and Richard (1981, 916) and Persson and Tabellini (2000, 51) for a lengthier exposition of the model.
6. A formal proof is available from the author. The prediction is more ambiguous in a model that incorporates both public policy and private transfers. It is hard to see, however, how higher turnout rates should result in a welfare loss for the newly turned-out.
7. Several relevant unpublished studies were identified and are noted in the supplemental appendix, but there number was too few to affect the results either way.
8. The two-tailed sign tests were performed in Excel using the binomial distribution function BINOMDIST(.).
9. The test is two-tailed. The *p*-value also includes the probability of observing 24 or more failures.

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Supplemental Online Appendix

I. Overview of methodology

All told, the data collection produced 74 studies. The author sorted the literature into the following cells in order to evaluate the theoretical claims of the paper, as described in the text. The title and abstracts of the identified studies are listed below by cell. Within each cell the studies are arranged alphabetically with a brief rationale for the coding wherever the decision seemed ambiguous.

Table 1: Frequency table of empirical turnout studies

	Dependent variable is policy liberalism/conservatism	Dependent variable is partisan vote shares
Independent variable is structural change in turnout	**I.** **Hypothesis:** Assuming the turnout change leads to a sustained leftward shift of the electorate, policy should shift left. **N = 31** 77.4% find a positive effect (N=24) 3.2% find a negative effect (N=1) 19.4% find zero effect (N=6)	**II.** **Hypothesis:** Parties should anticipate the change in turnout and update their policies accordingly. There should be no change in Left's vote share, per the spatial model. **N = 12** 17.7% find a positive effect (N=2) 0% find a negative effect (N=0) 83.3% find zero effect (N=10)
Independent variable is non-structural change in turnout	**III.** **Hypothesis:** Ambiguous. To the extent that turnout change is unexpected or expected to be temporary, it should not lead to a leftward policy shift. **N= 5** 60% find a positive effect (N=3) 0% find a negative effect (N=0) 40% find zero effect (N=2)	**IV.** **Hypothesis:** Ambiguous. Depends on the reason for the non-structural turnout change. Mobilization campaigns should benefit the party that launched them. Neutral turnout shocks should be uncorrelated with vote shares. **N = 26** 34.6% find a positive effect (N=9) 6.3% find a negative effect (N=1) 61.5% find zero effect (N=16)

To identify relevant studies the following Boolean search was conducted in Jstor, Google Scholar, Worldwide Political Science Abstracts, EconLit and the Web of Science: ((turnout OR suffrage OR franchise) AND (policy OR outcomes OR "vote shares" OR "election results")).

For example, the Jstor database search included all content in the article in the fields of: African studies, American studies, Area studies, Asian studies, British studies, Development studies, Economics, History, Latin American studies, Political science, Social sciences, and some other related fields. This search produced 47,138 hits arranged by relevance. The author read the title and abstract of each of the first 1,000 hits and determined that the later hits had very little relevance. Another important data collection technique was simply flipping through the works cited pages of previously identified studies. All told, 74 studies were deemed to be germane. As noted in the text, due to their varied research design and operationalization of the theoretical constructs, it was not possible to estimate an average treatment effect across the studies as is sometimes possible in experimental fields.

II. Notes regarding coding decisions

(1.) Regarding Cell IV: Gil, Mulligan, and Sala-i-Martin (2004) and Perotti, (1996) forcefully argue that there is no relationship between "democracy" and any policy outcome in a cross section of countries. Persson and Tabellini (2004) find the opposite. These studies and numerous similar ones were excluded from the analysis because they focus on measures such as Polity scores as their measure of democratization, not voter turnout (see, e.g., Acemoglu and Robinson 2000; Boix 2003; Gradstein and Milanovic 2005).

(2.) Regarding Cell IV: Radcliff's (1994) results were questioned by Erikson (1995) – who showed contrary results – and then re-affirmed by Radcliff (1995). We counted Radcliff's two studies as a single finding.

(3.) As noted in the text, Hajnal and Trounstine (2008) were excluded because the outcome was descriptive representation, not left vote shares or policy.

(4.) Regarding Cell III: Hicks and Swanks' (1992) conclusion was convincingly revised by Beck and Katz (1995: 643) who used superior methods and concluded that there was no significant effect of structural turnout on partisan vote shares.

(5) Regarding Cells II and IV: Though it contains some useful evidence, it was decided to exclude Herron's (1998) working paper because it remains unpublished. That paper concluded full turnout would have won Dukaksis the 1988 presidential bid. (http://www.polmeth.wustl.edu/media/Paper/herro98b.pdf).

The following interesting dissertations were also excluded because they were not published, but contain many useful insights:
Seth Hill (2010) "Changing Composition and Changing Allegiance in American Politics." Doctoral Dissertation, University of California, Los Angeles.. Sarah Sled (2008). "It's in the Mail: The Effect of Vote By Mail Balloting on Voter Turnout and Policy Outcomes in U.S. Elections." Doctoral Dissertation, Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

I. Summary of coding decisions by cell

Study id	Cell	Author(s)	DV	Turnout type	Prediction success
1	I	Abrams and Settle (1999)	Policy	Struct	1
2	I	Acemoglu, et al.(2013)	Policy	Struct	1
3	I	Aidt, Dutta and Loukoianova (2006)	Policy	Struct	1
4	I	Aidt and Eterovic (2011)	Policy	Struct	1
5	I	Aidt, Dutta and Dauntan (2010)	Policy	Struct	0
6	I	Aidt and Dallal (2008)	Policy	Struct	1
7	I	Aidt and Jensen (2009)	Policy	Struct	1
8	I	Aidt, Toke, and Jensen (2009)	Policy	Struct	0
9	I	Avery and Peffley (2005)	Policy	Struct	1
10	I	Bechtel, et al. (2013)	Policy	Struct	1
11	I	Berry and Gersen (2011)	Policy	Struct	1
12	I	Cascio and Washington (2014)	Policy	Struct	1
13	I	Fleck (2002)	Policy	Struct	1
14	I	Fowler (2013)	Policy	Struct	1
15	I	Fumagali and Narcisco	Policy	Struct	1
16	I	Franseze (2002)	Policy	Struct	1
17	I	Gleason (2001)	Policy	Struct	0
18	I	Husted and Kenny (1997)	Policy	Struct	1
19	I	Keech (1968)	Policy	Struct	1
20	I	Klug (2001)	Policy	Struct	1
21	I	Larcinese	Policy	Struct	1
22	I	Lindert (2004)	Policy	Struct	1
23	I	Lndert (1994)	Policy	Struct	1
24	I	Lizzeri and Persico (2004)	Policy	Struct	1
25	I	Lott and Kenny (1999)	Policy	Struct	1
26	I	Mahler (2008)	Policy	Struct	1
27	I	Miller (2008)	Policy	Struct	1
28	I	Madcliff and Saiz (1995)	Policy	Struct	0
29	I	Skocpol, et al. (1993)	Policy	Struct	1
30	I	Scheve and Stasavage (2010)	Policy	Struct	0
31	I	Timmons (2010)	Policy	Struct	0
				N successes:	**24**
1	II	Berlinski and Dewan (2011)	Vote share	Struct	1
2	II	Bernhagen and Marsh (2007)	Vote share	Struct	1
3	II	Burch (2012)	Vote share	Struct	1
4	II	Calvert and Gilchrist (1993)	Vote share	Struct	1
5	II	Larcinese (2011)	Vote share	Struct	1
6	II	Fowler (2013)	Vote share	Struct	0
7	II	Knack and White (1998)	Partisan regn.	Struct	1
8	II	Matthew, et al. (1976)	Vote share	Struct	1
9	II	Peterson and Rose (2007)	Vote share	Struct	1
10	II	Stein (1988)	Vote share	Struct	1
11	II	Stephens (1977)	Vote share	Struct	1
12	II	Uggen and Mansa (2002)	Vote share	Struct	0

				N successes:	10
Study id	**Cell**	**Author(s)**	**DV**	**Turnout type**	**Turnout effect**
1	III	Hicks and Swank (1992) (Beck & Katz revised)	Policy	¬Struct	0
2	III	Hill and Leighley (1992)	Policy	¬Struct	1
3	III	Hill, et al. (1995)	Policy	¬Struct	1
4	III	Larcinese (2007)	Policy	¬Struct	1
5	III	Martin (2003)	Policy	¬Struct	1
6	III	Mueller and Stratmann (2003)	Policy	¬Struct	0
1	IV	Aguilar, et al. (2000)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
2	IV	Bohrer, et al. (2000)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
3	IV	Brunell and Dinardo (2004)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
4	IV	Citrin, Schickler and Sides (2003)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
5	IV	Denardo (1995)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
6	IV	Erikson (1995)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
7	IV	Fisher (2007)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
8	IV	Gomez et al. (2007)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
9	IV	Hansford and Gomez (2010)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
10	IV	Highton and Wolfinger (2001)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
11	IV	Knack (1994)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
12	IV	Lee and Hwang (2012)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
13	IV	Lutz (2007)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
14	IV	Martinez and Gill (a) (2005)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
15	IV	Martinez and Gill (b)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
16	IV	Mcallister and Mughan (1986)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
17	IV	Nagel and McNulty (1996)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
18	IV	Nagel (1988)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
19	IV	Pacek and Radcliff (a) (1995)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
20	IV	Pacek and Radcliff (b) (2003)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
21	IV	Radcliff (1994, 1995)	Vote share	¬Struct	1
22	IV	Rubenson, et al. (2007)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
23	IV	Saglie (2012)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
24	IV	Sides, Schickler, and Citrin (2008)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
25	IV	Toka and Popescu (2007/2008)	Vote share	¬Struct	0
26	IV	Tucker and Vedlitz (1986)	Vote share	¬Struct	1

IV. Abstracts and individual coding decisions by cell

The coding decision is indicated as follows. Green indicates that the study found a positive turnout effect – i.e., higher turnout rates advantage those turnout or lower turnout rates disadvantaged those who did not turn out. Red indicates that the study found a negative turnout effect (as in the post-VRA South). Blue indicates the study's conclusions found no significant in either direction.

Cell I.

(1) Title: *Women's Suffrage and the Growth of the Welfare State*
Author(s): Burton A. Abrams; Russell F. Settle
Source: Public Choice, Vol. 100, No. 3/4 (1999), pp. 289-300
Publisher(s): Springer
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/30026099
Abstract: In this paper we test the hypothesis that extensions of the voting franchise to include lower income people lead to growth in government, especially growth in redistribution expenditures. The empirical analysis takes advantage of the natural experiment provided by Switzerland's extension of the franchise to women in 1971. Women's suffrage represents an institutional change with potentially significant implications for the positioning of the decisive voter. For various reasons, the decisive voter is more likely to favor increases in governmental social welfare spending following the enfranchisement of women. **Evidence indicates that this extension of voting rights increased Swiss social welfare spending by 28% and increased the overall size of the Swiss government.**

(2) Title: *Democracy, redistribution and inequality*.
Authors: Acemoglu, Daron, et al.
Source: No. w19746. National Bureau of Economic Research, 2013.
In this paper we revisit the relationship between democracy, redistribution and inequality. We first explain the theoretical reasons why democracy is expected to increase redistribution and reduce inequality, and why this expectation may fail to be realized when democracy is captured by the richer segments of the population; when it caters to the preferences of the middle class; or when it opens up disequalizing opportunities to segments of the population previously excluded from such activities, thus exacerbating inequality among a large part of the population. We then survey the existing empirical literature, which is both voluminous and full of contradictory results. We provide new and systematic reduced-form evidence on the dynamic impact of democracy on various outcomes. **Our findings indicate that there is a significant and robust effect of democracy on tax revenues as a fraction of GDP**, but no robust impact on inequality. We also find that democracy is associated with an increase in secondary schooling and a more rapid structural transformation. Finally, we provide some evidence suggesting that inequality tends to increase after democratization when the economy has already undergone significant structural transformation, when land inequality is high, and when the gap between the middle class and the poor is small. All of these are broadly consistent with a view that is different from the traditional median voter model of democratic redistribution: democracy does not lead to a uniform decline in post-tax inequality, but can result in changes in fiscal redistribution.

(3) Title "Democracy comes to Europe: franchise extension and fiscal outcomes 1830–1938."
Authors: Aidt, T. S., Dutta, J., & Loukoianova, E. (2006).
Source: *European Economic Review*, *50*(2), 249-283.

This paper examines the relation between public spending and the spread of democracy in Western Europe during the period 1830–1938. Our data set includes measures of the size of the electorate, the election rule, and electoral participation, as well as measures of the size and composition of central government expenditures for 12 countries. **We estimate panel regressions, and find that (1) the gradual lifting of socio-economic restrictions on the voting franchise contributed to growth in government spending mainly by increasing spending on infrastructure and internal security; (2) the female suffrage had a weak positive effect, through spending on health, education and welfare**; (3) the change from majority to proportional rule, which took place in 10 of the countries, did not contribute to growth in government spending, and held back spending on health, education and welfare; (4) there exists (weak) complementarity between economic development and the spread of democracy.

(4) Title: Political competition, electoral participation and public finance in 20th century Latin America.
Authors: Aidt, T.S., Eterovic, D.S., 2011.
Source: European Journal of Political Economy 27, 181–200.
Rational choice models predict that political competition and political participation have opposite effects on the size of government. We investigate these theories using data from a panel of 18 Latin American countries during the 20th century. Our research builds evidence for the prediction that reforms enhancing political competition tend to limit the size of government, while reforms increasing political participation tend to increase the size of government. Furthermore, **we find that reforms which remove literacy requirements from franchise laws are associated with governmental expansion**, while changes in women's suffrage laws have no impact on the size of government. Our findings demonstrate the empirical relevance of the distinction between political competition and participation.

(5) Title: The retrenchment hypothesis and the extension of the franchise in England and Wales.
Authors: Aidt, T.S., Dutta, J., Dauntan, M., 2010.
Source: The Economic Journal 120, 990–1020.
Does an extension of the voting franchise always increase public spending or can it be a source of retrenchment? We study this question in the context of public spending on health-related urban amenities in a panel of municipal boroughs from England and Wales in 1868, 1871 and 1886. **We find evidence of a U-shaped relationship between spending on urban amenities and the extension of the local voting franchise.** Our model of taxpayer democracy suggests that the retrenchment effect was related to enfranchisement of the middle class through nation-wide reforms and that these reforms might have been Pareto inferior in the average borough.

(6) Title: *Female Voting Power: The Contribution of Women's Suffrage to the Growth of Social Spending in Western Europe (1869-1960)*
Author(s): Toke S. Aidt; Bianca Dallal
Source: Public Choice, Vol. 134, No. 3/4 (Mar., 2008), pp. 391-417
Publisher(s): Springer
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/27698233
Abstract: Women's suffrage was a major event in the history of democratization in Western Europe and elsewhere. Public choice theory predicts that the demand for publicly funded social spending is systematically higher where women have and use the right to vote. Using historical data from six Western European countires for the period 1869–1960, **we provide evidence that social spending out of GDP increased by 0.6–1.2% in the short-run as a consequence of women's suffrage, while the long-run effect is three to eight times larger**. We also explore a number of other public finance implications of the gender gap.

(7) Title: Tax structure, size of government, and the extension of the voting franchise in Western Europe, 1860–1938.
Authors: Aidt, T. S., & Jensen, P. S. (2009).
Source: *International Tax and Public Finance*, *16*(3), 362-394.

We study the consequences of the extension of the voting franchise for the size of (central) government and for the tax structure in ten western European countries, 1860–1938. The main hypothesis under investigation is that the impact of the franchise extension on the tax structure is conditional on tax collection costs. **We find that the share of direct taxes (including the personal income tax) is positively affected by the franchise extension, but only if relative tax collection costs are below a given threshold.** We use literacy as a proxy for the cost of levying a broad-based income tax. **We also show that the gradual relaxation of income and wealth restrictions on the right to vote contributed to growth in total government spending and taxation**.

(8) Title: *The taxman tools up: An event history study of the introduction of the personal income tax*

Source: *Journal of Public Economics* 93.1 (2009): 160-175.
Authors: Aidt, Toke S., and Peter S. Jensen. 2009.
Abstract: The introduction of income taxation was a landmark in the historical development of the fiscal state of the now developed world. This paper presents an event history study of the adoption of the income tax in 17 countries from western Europe, north America, Oceania and Japan between 1815 and 1939. We find evidence that spending pressures, reductions in tax collection costs and to a lesser extent social learning played a significant role for the adoption decision. **We also find evidence that the extension of the franchise at first reduced the likelihood of adoption of the income tax, but eventually as universal suffrage was approached increased the likelihood**.

(9) Title: *Voter Registration Requirements, Voter Turnout, and Welfare Eligibility Policy: Class Bias Matters*

Author(s): James M. Avery and Mark Peffley
Source: State Politics & Policy Quarterly, Vol. 5, No. 1 (Spring, 2005), pp. 47-67
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/40421537
Abstract: The 1990s saw some of the most dramatic changes in the American social welfare system in recent decades at both the national and state levels. In particular, states were granted, and took advantage of, much wider latitude in deciding who is eligible to receive welfare benefits. To what extent did the composition of a state's electorate influence the restrictiveness of the welfare eligibility requirements it adopted at this time? **We find that in states where lower-class voter turnout was comparable to that of the upper class, lawmakers were less likely to pass restrictive welfare eligibility rules.** We also find that electorates in states with restrictive voter registration laws are much more likely to be biased toward upper-class turnout. Thus, lower-class voter mobilization can affect the ability of the disadvantaged to achieve policies consistent with their interests, but state voter registration laws pose a substantial barrier to such mobilization.

(10) Title: "Direct Democracy, Turnout, and the Public Policy Effects of Compulsory Voting."

Turnout, and the Public Policy Effects of Compulsory Voting
Authors: Bechtel, Michael M., Dominik Hangartner, and Lukas Schmid.
Source: *(November 22, 2013)* (2013).
Citizens unequally participate in elections and this may systematically bias policy in favor of those who vote. Many view compulsory voting as an important tool to alleviate
this problem, but we still know very little about its policy consequences. We argue that
sanctioned compulsory voting mobilizes citizens at the bottom of the income distribution
and that this translates into an increase in support for redistributive policies. We empirically explore the effects of a sanctioned compulsory voting law on direct-democratic decisionmaking in the Swiss canton of Vaud from 1908 to 1947, a formative period for the welfare state. **We find that compulsory voting increases turnout in referendums by 30 percentage points to over 85% on average and doubles electoral support for left policy positions.** We discuss the implications of these results for our understanding of the policy consequences of electoral institutions and the evolution of the modern welfare state.

(11) Election timing and public policy.
Authors: Berry, Christopher R., and Jacob E. Gersen.
Source: *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 6, no. 2 (2011): 103-135.

This paper makes use of variation in the timing of local elections to shed light on one of the core questions in democratic politics: what would happen if everyone voted? Does a low voter turnout rate imply that a small subset of special interest voters controls politics and policy? Or, are voters largely representative of non-voters such that neither the outcomes of elections nor resulting public policies would change even if everyone participated? Rather than rely on surveys of nonvoters to extrapolate their hypothetical behavior, we rely on a natural experiment created by a 1980s change in the California Election Code, which allowed school districts to change their elections from off-cycle to on-cycle. Because we are able to observe very large within-district changes in voter turnout resulting from changes in election timing, we are able to isolate the effect of turnout on policy outcomes, including teacher salaries and student achievement tests. Our analysis demonstrates that changes in voter turnout do affect public policy, but modestly.

(12) Title: "Valuing the Vote: The Redistribution of Voting Rights and State Funds Following the Voting Rights Act of 1965."
Authors: Cascio, E. and E. Washington
Source: *Quarterly Journal of Economics,* (2014)
The Voting Rights Act of 1965, called one of the most effective pieces of civil rights legislation in U.S. history, generated dramatic increases in black voter registration across the South. We ask whether the increase in black voting rights was accompanied by an increase in blacks' share of public spending. We exploit a key provision of the act—removal of literacy tests at registration—for identification. Employing a triple-difference framework over a 20-year period, **we find that counties with higher black population shares in former literacy test states saw greater increases in both voter turnout and state transfers than comparison counties in non–literacy test states**, a finding that is consistent with models of distributive politics.

(13) Title: "Democratic opposition to the fair labor standards act of 1938."
Author: Fleck, Robert K.
Source: *The Journal of Economic History* 62.01 (2002): 25-54.
This article uses roll-call voting and constituency data to provide an improved understanding of how and why the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) of 1938 divided the Democratic Party. The evidence suggests, first, that **the predominance of southerners among Democrats who opposed the FLSA resulted in part from the widespread disfranchisement of low-wage workers** in the South and, second, that Democratic opposition to the FLSA in the House of Representatives reflected a weakening of the coalition that had passed so much legislation during the earlier years of the New Deal.

(14) Title: **Electoral and Policy Consequences of Voter Turnout: Evidence from Compulsory Voting in Australia.**
Author: Fowler, A.
Source: *Quarterly Journal of Political Science*, (2013). *8*(2), 159-182.
Despite extensive research on voting, there is little evidence connecting turnout to tangible outcomes. Would election results and public policy be different if everyone voted? The adoption of compulsory voting in Australia provides a rare opportunity to address this question. First, I collect two novel data sources to assess the extent of turnout inequality in Australia before compulsory voting. Overwhelmingly, wealthy citizens voted more than their working-class counterparts. Next, exploiting the differential adoption of compulsory voting across states, I find that the policy increased voter turnout by 24 percentage points which in turn increased the vote shares and seat shares of the Labor Party by 7–10 percentage points. **Finally, comparing across OECD countries, I find that Australia's adoption of compulsory voting significantly increased turnout and pension spending at the national level**. Results suggest that democracies with voluntary voting do not represent the preferences of all citizens. Instead, increased voter turnout can dramatically alter election outcomes and resulting public policies.

(15) Title "Political Participation, Income Distribution, and Public Transfers in Developed Democracies."
Author: Franseze, Robert. 2002.
Source: University of Michigan, Ann Arbor. Unpublished manuscript.
Abstract: In the postwar era until recently, transfer payments have risen seemingly inexorably as a fraction of GDP in every developed democracy. A considerable body of positive theory purports to explain this development as a direct consequence of the differential distributions of political (votes) and economic (money) resources. This literature concludes, inter alia, that the size of tax- and transfer systems (T&T) increases in the pre-T&T skew of the income distribution. This paper builds from that basis, suggesting theoretical additions and amendments deriving from further consideration of the political processes that transform resources into influence. It particularly emphasizes that not everyone participates politically and that participants and non-participants are not randomly selected. Together these facts imply that the response of T&T to changes in income inequality will be mediated by participation rates and, vice versa, the response to increases in participation will be mediated by income inequality. The paper then empirically evaluates the emergent set of theoretical expectations based on the post-war experience of developed democracies.

(16) Title: "Political Institutions, Voter Turnout and Policy Outcomes."
Authors: Fumagalli and Narciso
Source: European Jounal of Political Economy.
This paper tests whether constitutions directly affect economic outcomes. By introducing citizens' political participation as the driving force connecting institutions to policy outcomes, we empirically show that voter turnout is the channel through which forms of government affect economic policies. We provide evidence of the existence of two relationships. First, presidential regimes appear to be associated with lower voter participation in national elections. Second, higher voter participation induces an increase in government expenditure, total revenues, welfare state spending, and budget deficit. We conclude that forms of government affect policy outcomes only through voter turnout.

(17) Title*: Female Political Participation and Health in India*
Author(s): Suzanne Gleason
Source: Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Science, Vol. 573, Culture and Development: International Perspectives (Jan., 2001), pp. 105-126
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/1049017
Abstract: This article uses a unique data set to investigate the determinants of political participation in India. In particular, the data from the 1981 census of India are coupled with electoral returns from 1979-80 to examine the factors influencing participation of both genders. Differential impact is explored empirically. Many of the same influences found to be important in developed countries are relevant in India, including income, education, and constituency culture. In addition, labor force participation and familial obligations have an effect, though in the opposite direction from that predicted in the United States. A lack of government-provided resources devoted to health and education also influences participation. **A second investigation uses the same census data with 1977-78 election returns to estimate government response to female political participation in India.** Regarding the causes of child mortality, no effect of female participation on health outcomes was found. **This may result from the aggregation necessary to match census districts and voting const**

(18) Title: *The Effect of the Expansion of the Voting Franchise on the Size of Government*
Author(s): Thomas A. Husted; Lawrence W. Kenny
Source: Journal of Political Economy, Vol. 105, No. 1 (Feb., 1997), pp. 54-82
Publisher(s): The University of Chicago Press
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/2138871
Abstract: This paper examines the claim that expansion of the voting franchise has been an important factor in the growth of government. State government spending and state and local spending are explained using a panel of 46 states for 1950-88. Elimination of poll taxes and

literacy tests led to higher turnout, particularly among the poor, and a poorer pivotal voter. As predicted, we find that these changes, **a fall in the income of voters relative to state income, and the ouster of Republicans from state government led to a sharp rise in welfare spending** but no change in other spending.

(19) Title: *The Impact of Negro Voting: The Role of the Vote in the Quest for Equality*
Author: Keech, W. R. (1968).
Source: Chicago: Rand McNally.

(20) Title: *Why Chamberlain failed and Bismarck succeeded: The political economy of tariffs in British and German elections*
Author: Adam Klug
Source: European Review of Economic History, Vol. 5, No. 2, German Cliometrics (AUGUST 2001), pp. 219-250
Publisher(s): Oxford University Press
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/41377896
Abstract: This article analyses three crucial elections which determined the fate of free trade in Britain and Germany. These are the elections of 1906 in the UK and 1877 and 1878 in Germany. We examine the political economy of trade policy by examining the voting patterns of the electorates in their choice of commercial policy. The underlying hypothesis to be explored is that voting behaviour was based on the economic interests of the constituents as determined by the international trade performance of the sector in which they were employed. An econometric model reveals the degree to which the support for and opposition to free trade was based on occupational characteristics and well explains the outcome for Germany in 1877. The analysis for Britain extends previous work by Irwin (1994) by assessing how considerations of turnout, religion and restricted voting rights alter the results of his original model. In 1878 in Germany religious affiliation and turnout played a significant role in the result although not in the ways assumed by historians, in particular the outcome of the election was not determined by the mobilisation of agricultural labourers on the great estates. **The results of estimating the model shows that franchise restrictions contributed to the victory of free trade in Britain,** but their absence had no impact on the result in Germany.

(21) Title: "*Voting over redistribution and the size of the welfare state: The role of turnout*."
Author(s): Larcinese, Valentino
Source: *Political Studies* 55.3 (2007): 568-585.
Abstract: Theories of redistribution inspired by the Downsian model receive little support from empirical investigation. In this article I argue that one of the possible explanations is that the standard Downsian theory, and the empirical specifications derived from it, ignore electoral turnout. Empirical evidence consistently shows that higher-income citizens are more likely to vote; office-seeking candidates should therefore include this probability in their objective function.As a consequence, the pivotal voter is not the median in the income distribution, but is generally richer. Moreover, an increase in income inequality does not unambiguously increase the political demand for redistribution, as most literature takes for granted. Including turnout in the model restores the compatibility of the Downsian theory with current empirical evidence.A regression analysis on panel data for 41 countries in the period 1972–98 confirms the importance of turnout as an explanatory variable for social spending.

(22) Title: *Growing Public: Social Spending and Economic Growth since the Eighteenth Century, Volumes I and II*
Author: Lindert, Peter. 2004
Source: Cambridge University Press.

(23) Title: "The rise of social spending, 1880-1930."
Author: Lindert, Peter.
Source: *Explorations in Economic History* (1994) 31: 1-36.

(24) Why did the Elites Extend the Suffrage? Democracy and the Scope of Government, with an Application to Britain's" Age of Reform".
Authors: Lizzeri, A., & Persico, N. (2004).
Source: *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 707-765.
A new rationale is presented for why an elite may want to expand the franchise even in the absence of threats to the established order. Expanding the franchise can turn politicians away from particularistic politics based on ad personam redistribution within the elite and foster competition based on programs with diffuse benefits. If these programs are valuable, a majority of the elite votes in favor of an extension of the franchise despite the absence of a threat from the disenfranchised. We argue that the evolution of public spending and of political competition I nineteenth century Britain is consistent with our model.

(25) Title: *Did Women's Suffrage Change the Size and Scope of Government?*
Author(s): John R. Lott, Jr.,; Lawrence W. Kenny
Source: Journal of Political Economy, Vol. 107, No. 6 (December 1999), pp. 1163-1198
Publisher(s): The University of Chicago Press
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/10.1086/250093
Abstract: This paper examines the growth of government during this century as a result of giving women the right to vote. Using cross-sectional time-series data for 1870–1940, we examine state government expenditures and revenue as well as voting by U.S. House and Senate state delegations and the passage of a wide nrange of different state laws. **Suffrage coincided with immediate increases in state government expenditures and revenue and more liberal voting patterns for federal representatives, and these effects continued growing over time as more women took advantage of the franchise.** Contrary to many recent suggestions, the gender gap is not something that has arisen since the 1970s, and it helps explain why American government started growing when it did.

(26) Title: "Electoral turnout and income redistribution by the state: A cross-national analysis of the developed democracies."
Author: Mahler, Vincent A.
Source: *European Journal of Political Research* (2008). 47 (2): 161-83.
This article explores the sources of variation in state redistribution across 13 developed democracies over the period 1979–2000, drawing upon data from the International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance, the Luxembourg Income Study and the Comparative Study of Electoral Systems. The discussion begins with the median voter hypothesis, which predicts that the extent of state redistribution in a country will be positively related to the degree of pre-government inequality. In seeking to extend the median voter approach, the article takes into account two additional variables: the level of electoral turnout and the degree to which turnout is skewed by income. The analysis confirms that pre-government inequality is indeed positively related to state redistribution. However, the predictive power of the median voter approach is significantly improved when account is taken of the level of electoral turnout and the extent to which the turnout rate reflects an income skew – variables that are themselves related. The link between turnout and redistribution is especially strong for social transfers as opposed to taxes, and for the lower and middle, as opposed to the upper, part of the income spectrum.

(27) Title: *Women's Suffrage, Political Responsiveness, and Child Survival in American History*
Author(s): Grant Miller
Source: The Quarterly Journal of Economics, Vol. 123, No. 3 (Aug., 2008), pp. 1287-1327
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/25098929
Abstract: Women's choices appear to emphasize child welfare more than those of men. This paper presents new evidence on how suffrage rights for American women helped children to benefit from the scientific breakthroughs of the bacteriological revolution. Consistent with standard models of electoral competition, suffrage laws were followed by immediate shifts in legislative behavior and large, sudden increases in local public health spending. This growth in

public health spending fueled large-scale door-to-door hygiene campaigns, and child mortality declined by 8-15% (or 20,000 annual child deaths nationwide) as cause-specific reductions

(28) Title: "Race, Turnout, and Public Policy in the American States"
Authors: Radcliff, Benjamin and Martin Saiz, (1995).
Source: Political Research Quarterly, 48(3), 775-794.
We attempt to bridge the conceptual gap between the black politics and state politics literatures by studying the effect of racial differences in electoral participation on public policy. If state politics has considered whether "voters matter," and black politics has asked whether "black elected officials matter," we attempt to determine if "black voters matter." In particular, we ask whether, and how, the racial composition of the electorate affects state policies. Our results suggest that the greater black participation relative to that of whites, the less liberal are state policies. The implications for democratic theory and black politics are discussed.

(29) Title: Women's associations and the enactment of mothers' pensions in the United States

Author(s): Skocpol, T., Abend-Wein, M., Howard, C., & Lehmann, S. G. (1993)..
Source: *American Political Science Review*, *87*(03), 686-701.

(30) Title: *The Conscription of Wealth: Mass Warfare and the Demand for Progressive Taxation*
Author(s): Kenneth Scheve and David Stasavage
Source: International Organization, Vol. 64, No. 4 (Fall 2010), pp. 529-561
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/40930448
Abstract: The dominant narrative of the politics of redistribution in political science and economics highlights the signature role of the rise of electoral democracy and the development of political parties that mobilize working-class groups. We argue in this article that this narrative ignores the critical role played by mass warfare in the development of redistributive public policies. Focusing attention on the determinants of progressive taxation, we argue that mobilization for mass warfare led to demands for increased taxation of the wealthy to more fairly distribute the burden for the war effort. We then show empirically that during the past century, mass mobilization for war has been associated with a notable increase in tax progressivity. **In the absence of war, neither the establishment of universal suffrage, nor the arrival of political control by parties of the left is systematically associated with large increases in tax progressivity**. In making these arguments, we devote particular attention to a "difference-in-differences" comparison of participants and nonparticipants in World War I.

(31) Title: *Taxation and Representation in Recent History*
Author(s): Jeffrey F. Timmons
Source: The Journal of Politics, Vol. 72, No. 1 (Jan., 2010), pp. 191-208
Publisher(s): Cambridge University Press on behalf of the Southern Political Science Association
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/20622407
Abstract: This paper disaggregates government accounts to examine whether and how representation affects the level and distribution of taxation. Using panel data for over 100 countries from 1970 to 1999 and cross-sectional data for approximately 75 democracies from 1990 to 1998, we find that both democratization and voter turnout induced a modest but highly systematic increase in revenue from regressive taxes on consumption. While one-third of the increase due to democratization reflects a shift from more inefficient and similarly regressive taxes on trade, most of it was new revenue. Less convincingly, democratization and voter turnout also increased total tax revenue. **By contrast, neither democracy, nor voter turnout systematically increased revenue from progressive taxes on income and capital**. With reasonable assumptions about tax incidence and participation patterns, these findings shed light on competing conceptions of taxation and representation.

Cell II.

(1) Title: "The Political Consequences of Franchise Extension: Evidence From the Second Reform Act"
Authors: Berlinski, Samuel, and Torun Dewan.
Source: *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 6.34 (2011): 329-376.
Abstract. We use evidence from the Second Reform Act, introduced in the United Kingdom in 1867, to analyze the impact on electoral outcomes of extending the vote to the unskilled urban population. Exploiting the sharp change in the electorate caused by franchise extension, we separate the effect of reform from that of underlying constituency level traits correlated with the voting population. Although we find that the franchise affected electoral competition and candidate selection, **there is no evidence relating Liberal electoral support to changes in the franchise rules**. Our results are robust to various sources of endogeneity.

(2) "The partisan effects of low turnout: Analyzing vote abstention as a missing data problem."
Authors: Bernhagen, Patrick, and Michael Marsh.
Source: *Electoral Studies* 26, no. 3 (2007): 548-560.

We propose a novel method for estimating the partisan effects of low voter turnout. Treating non-voters as missing data points on a variable measuring vote choice, we use a statistical model of multiple imputation to estimate the missing values on reported party choice at 28 elections in 25 countries in the Comparative Study of Electoral Systems dataset. Calculating the differences between observed and 'complete' (100%) turnout, we identify party and country-level conditions under which changes in turnout affect electoral outcomes. We also provide simulations of election outcomes for incremental changes in turnout. While our findings suggest few systematic gains from increased turnout for left-of-centre parties, we show that small parties and non-incumbents would benefit if everybody voted.
Conclusion: "At the level of parties, we found no evidence for either left, right, or centre parties gaining from full turnout scenarios." No country fixed effects used.

(3) Did Disfranchisement Laws Help Elect President Bush? New Evidence on the Turnout Rates and Candidate Preferences of Florida's Ex-Felons
Author: Burch, Traci.
Source: *Political Behavior,* 34: 1 (2012).
This paper re-examines the impact of Florida's disfranchisement law on the 2000 Presidential election. The analysis simulates outcomes in Florida under scenarios consistent with the turnout rates of Georgia and North Carolina ex-felons in 2000 and Florida ex-felons in 2008. Survey evidence on candidate preferences as well as data on ex-felon party registration in Florida and North Carolina are used to produce estimates of support for Bush and Gore among ex-felons. Based on the simulations, the ex-felon population in Florida would have favored Bush in 2000. Assuming that ex-felons supported Gore at rates similar to GSS respondents with at most a high school diploma, Bush would have defeated Gore by 4,925 and 7,048 votes, assuming turnout of 10 and 15%, respectively.

(4) Suppose They Held an Election and Almost Everybody Came!.
Authors: Calvert, J. W., & Gilchrist, J. (1993).
Source: *PS: Political Science & Politics*, *26*(04), 695-700.

(5) Title: "Effects of Motor Voter Legislation Voter Turnout, Registration, and Partisan Advantage in the 1992 Presidential Election."
Author: Franklin, Daniel P., and Eric E. Grier
Source *American Politics Research* 25.1 (1997): 104-117.

The 1992 presidential election featured nine states and the District of Columbia with effective motor voter laws on the books. In 1996 all states will be required to have similar motor voter procedures. We conduct a multivariate analysis to compare turnout differences, partisan behavior, and registration levels in motor voter and non-motor voter states. We find that rates of voter registration and turnout are significantly higher in motor voter states than in other states. In addition, it appears that these newly registered voters are just as likely to vote as other registered voters. We find no significant partisan advantage for either party in motor voter states.

(6) Title: "Enfranchisement and representation: Italy 1909-1913"
Author: Larcinese, Valentino.
Source: "*Unpublished Department of Government, London School of Economics, http://personal. lse. ac. uk/LARCINES/enfranchisement nov11. pdf* (2011).
This paper presents evidence on the consequences of the 1912 introduction of .quasi-universal male suffrage in Italy. The reform increased the electorate from slightly less than three million to 8,650,000 and left the electoral rules and the district boundaries unchanged. This allows us to exploit the heterogeneity in enfranchisement rates across electoral districts to identify the causal effects of franchise extension on a number of political outcomes. The reform caused an increase in the vote share of social reformers (Socialists, Republicans and Radicals), together referred to as the Estrema. **One standard deviation in the share of newly enfranchised voters over the total number of registered 1913 voters caused an increase of around 2% in votes for Estrema candidates but had no impact on their parliamentary net seat gains.** Enfranchisement had also no impact on the parliamentary representation of aristocracy and traditional elites. Other outcomes (the chances of having candidates from the Estrema and the Her.ndel-Hirshman index of electoral competition) were also unaffected, with the exception of turnout, which decreased. These findings show that de jure political equalization did not cause major changes to political representation, although the voting choices of the formerly and newly enfranchised citizens divered on average. This apparent puzzle is the consequence of the heterogeneity of the e.ect across a number of both social and political dimensions. The paper documents elite.s e.ort to minimize the political impact of the reform.
Comment: The author did find a statistically significant effect of the large structural turnout increase on vote shares but the size of the effect was very small, not large enough to alter seat shares in the national legislature.

(7) Title: Electoral and Policy Consequences of Voter Turnout: Evidence from Compulsory Voting in Australia.
Author: Fowler, A.
Source: *Quarterly Journal of Political Science*, (2013). *8*(2), 159-182.
Despite extensive research on voting, there is little evidence connecting turnout to tangible outcomes. Would election results and public policy be different if everyone voted? The adoption of compulsory voting in Australia provides a rare opportunity to address this question. First, I collect two novel data sources to assess the extent of turnout inequality in Australia before compulsory voting. Overwhelmingly, wealthy citizens voted more than their working-class counterparts. Next, exploiting the differential adoption of compulsory voting across states, **I find that the policy increased voter turnout by 24 percentage points which in turn increased the vote shares and seat shares of the Labor Party by 7–10 percentage points**. Finally, comparing across OECD countries, I find that Australia's adoption of compulsory voting significantly increased turnout and pension spending at the national level. Results suggest that democracies with voluntary voting do not represent the preferences of all citizens. Instead, increased voter turnout can dramatically alter election outcomes and resulting public policies.

(8) Did states' motor voter programs help the Democrats?.
Authors: Knack, S., & White, J. (1998).
Source: American Politics Research, *26*(3), 344-365.

We find that the balance of registrants affiliating with the two major parties does not change significantly when motor voter or mail-in programs are adopted. These findings, although consistent with most related research by political scientists, contradict the belief of most politicians that Democrats would benefit, as well as a spate of media reports (e.g., Earle, 1995) claiming that new motor voter registrants were disproportionately Republican.
Comment: The dependent variable here is actual partisan registration, not voting shares.

(9) Title: *The Franchise Factor in the Rise of the Labour Party*
6uthor(s): H. C. G. Matthew; R. I. McKibbin; J. A. Kay
Source: The English Historical Review, Vol. 91, No. 361 (Oct., 1976), pp. 723-752
Publisher(s): Oxford University Press
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/565640
Dr P. F. Clarke suggests that the Liberal performance is positively related to the level of enfranchisement. He very properly notes that this does not imply a causal relationship, so that it is not possible to draw the inference that those who were disenfranchised were predominantly Liberal: though he does suggest that the evidence points in that direction.' The correlation certainly exists: we find that in seats with a high degree of enfranchisement,2 the Liberals obtain 53-2 per cent of the total vote in January 19lO, as against 5o.6 per cent in seats with medium enfranchisement and 46.7 per cent where enfranchisement is low. **This correlation is however quite spurious, and disappears when proper account is taken of the dominant religious influence on Lancashire politics**. (**See the appendix)**

(10) "The dog that didn't bark: Would increased electoral turnout make a difference?."
Pettersen, Per Arnt, and Lawrence E. Rose.
Electoral Studies 26, no. 3 (2007): 574-588.
The question of whether increased electoral turnout would make a difference has long been a matter of interest to psephologists and laymen alike. Several approaches to this question have been employed, one of which has been an analysis of responses to survey questions about how non-voters *would have voted* had they actually voted. The problem with this approach is not only that it involves responses to a hypothetical question, but also that the responses are given *after* the election outcome is known and hence are subject to the impact of various post-election effects – "bandwagon effects" in particular. In the present article an alternative approach based on an analysis of *party sympathy scores* is pursued. Party sympathy scores are calculated among voters and non-voters alike. On the basis of this information, an algorithm is then used to estimate what percentage of potential voters were "lost" by the failure of different parties to mobilize non-voters with sympathy scores comparable to their voters, and thereby assess the impact of non-voting on the election outcome. Analyses are carried out using data from six national parliamentary elections held in Norway in the period from 1981 to 2001. Results indicate that the impact of higher levels of turnout is marginal at best.
Conclusion: The principal conclusion is rather that the impact of increased mobilization of sympathetic non-voters would have very marginal effects on the distribution of electoral support insofar as the assumptions of our model are valid

(11) Title: "Introduction: early voting."
Source: *Public Opinion Quarterly* (1998): 57-69.
Author: Stein, Robert M.

I fail to detect any significant partisan advantage among early voters.
Early voters were equally likely to be Republicans and Democrats and supporters of the candidates of both parties. Again, this finding is consistent with previous research that has shown that liberalized voting and registration procedures do not produce significant partisan advantages

(Franklin and Grier 1996; Governing 1995).

(12) Title: *The Changing Context of British Politics in the 1880s: The Reform Acts and the ormation of the Liberal Unionist Party*
Author(s): Hugh W. Stephens
Source: Social Science History, Vol. 1, No. 4 (Summer, 1977), pp. 486-501Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/1170794
This paper studies the effect of two acts: the Representation of the People (Franchise) Act, passed in 1884, and the Redistribution of Seats Act, passed the following year. These brought major innovations in the constituency and electoral system of parliament; J.P.D. Dunbabin believes that they were probably the greatest electoral reforms in the history of Britain and states that 1885 is often used as a dividing line between two political eras. The Franchise Act extended the right to vote to almost all male heads of households in the county constituencies or, put in broad occupational terms, to the agricultural laborers: this was similar to what had been granted to the borough constituencies in 1867. This action more or less standardized the franchise and represented the largest expansion of the British electorate to that time, raising the proportion of eligible voters from 28 percent to 58 percent of the adult male population. The Redistribution Act furthered the tentative innovations of 1832 and 1867 by making single member districts the rule and by reducing some of the disparities in the size of the district populations. The major purpose of this analysis is to determine the effects of the Franchise and Redistribution Acts, and the critical election of July, 1886, upon party alignment, particularly upon the formation of the Liberal Unionist party.
Comment: First-order correlations suggest that voter turnout at the district level did not have a sizable impact on Conservative and Liberal vote shares.

(13) "Democratic contraction? Political consequences of felon disenfranchisement in the United States."
Authors: Uggen, Christopher, and Jeff Manza.
Source: *American Sociological Review* (2002): 777-803.
Universal suffrage is a cornerstone of democratic governance. As levels of criminal punishment have risen in the United States, however, an ever-larger number of citi-zens have lost the right to vote. The authors ask whether felon disenfranchisement constitutes a meaningful reversal of the extension of voting rights by considering its political impact. Data from legal sources, election studies, and inmate surveys are examined to consider two counterfactual conditions: (1) whether removing disenfran-chisement restrictions alters the outcomes of past U.S. Senate and presidential elec-tions, and (2) whether applying contemporary rates of disenfranchisement to prior elections affects their outcomes. Because felons are drawn disproportionately from the ranks of racial minorities and the poor, disenfranchisement laws tend to take more votes from Democratic than from Republican candidates. Analysis shows that felon disenfranchisement played a decisive role in U.S. Senate elections in recent years. Moreover, at least one Republican presidential victory would have been reversed if former felons had been allowed to vote, and at least one Democratic presidential victory would have been jeopardized had contemporary rates of disenfranchisement prevailed during that time.

(14) Title: Political effects of low turnout in national and European elections.
Authors: Van der Eijk, C., & Van Egmond, M. (2007).
Source: *Electoral Studies*, *26*(3), 561-573.
This article estimates for member states of the EU the effect of low levels of turnout on parties' share of the vote in national elections. It does so by comparing the distribution of party choices in national elections for all those who participate in those elections on the one hand, and for the much more restricted group of those who participate in European Parliament elections on the other. As European elections register lower turnout than other nation-wide elections, this comparison provides an extreme, but empirically observed case of low turnout. Turnout effects prove comparatively small, and are non-negligible in only few cases. Turnout effects are slightly

different for different kinds of parties: right-wing parties benefit slightly from them (on average) and left-wing parties are (on average) somewhat hurt. Although significant, these differences are exceedingly small, and explain no more than a few percent of variation in turnout effects. No significant effects are found from other party characteristics (such as their size, government status, position on European integration, or interactions of these with government approval or time since the last national election). The analyses are based on data from European election studies in 1989, 1994, 1999 and 2004.

Cell III.

(1) Title: "Policies, Institutions, and Welfare Spending in Industrialized Democracies, 1960–82."
Author: Hicks, Alexander M., and Duane H. Swank. (1992).
Source: *American Political Science Review* 86(3):658– 74.
We examine the roles of democratic politics and political institutions in shaping social welfare spending in 18 contemporary capitalist democracies. We explore the social spending consequences of government partisanship, electoral competition and turnout, and the self-interested behaviors of politicians and bureaucrats, as well as such relatively durable facets of political institutions as neocorporatism, state centralization, and traditionalist policy legacies. Pooled time series analyses of welfare effort in 18 nations during the 1960–82 period show that electoral turnout, as well as left and center governments increase welfare effort; that the welfare efforts of governments led by particular types of parties show significant differences and vary notably with the strength of oppositional (and junior coalitional) parties; and that relatively neocorporatist, centralized, and traditionalistic polities are high on welfare effort. Overall, our findings suggest that contrary to many claims, both partisan and nonpartisan facets of democratic politics and political institutions shape contemporary social welfare effort.
Comment: (1995) Beck and Katz reanalyzed the data and found the effect was insignificant.

(2) Title: *The Policy Consequences of Class Bias in State Electorates*
Author(s): Kim Quaile Hill and Jan E. Leighley
Source: American Journal of Political Science, Vol. 36, No. 2 (May, 1992), pp. 351-365
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/2111481
Abstract: This paper tests the proposition that an electorate disproportionately representative of higher-class citizens will be rewarded with public policies in favor of its economic interests and at the expense of the interests of lower-class citizens. **We find a consistent negative relationship between the degree of class bias favoring the upper class and the generosity of indigenous state social welfare spending.** We also find that it is the underrepresentation of the poor, rather than the overrepresentation of the wealthy, that principally explains this relationship. These findings have important implications for democratic theory generally and for present-day concern about the composition of the U.S. electorate.
Comment: The study looks across states so it is likely that the variance in turnout is attributable to structural variation. The study was included in this cell because the authors did not include state fixed effects.

(3) Title: *Lower-Class Mobilization and Policy Linkage in the U.S. States*
Author(s): Kim Quaile Hill, Jan E. Leighley and Angela Hinton-Andersson
Source: American Journal of Political Science, Vol. 39, No. 1 (Feb., 1995), pp. 75-86
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/2111758
Abstract: Political participation by lower class voters should create pressures for government to respond with supportive policies. Lower class voting is associated with more generous state welfare policies. Political forces and institutions structure this relationship. A pooled time series analysis for the 50 U.S. states from 1978 to 1990. **We demonstrate an enduring relationship between the degree of mobilization of lower-class voters and the generosity of welfare**

benefits provided by state governments. This relationship can be vitiated by remarkable political and economic events such as the "new federalism" and the economic recession in the early 1980s. Finally, the importance of lower-class mobilization for redistributive policy is enhanced by the liberalism and competitiveness of state Democratic parties.
Comment: The study looks across states so it is likely that the variance in turnout is attributable to structural variation. The study was included in this cell because the authors did not include state fixed effects.

(4) Title: "*Voting over redistribution and the size of the welfare state: The role of turnout*."
Author: Larcinese, Valentino.
Source: Political Studies 55.3 (2007): 568-585.
Theories of redistribution inspired by the Downsian model receive little support from empirical investigation. In this article I argue that one of the possible explanations is that the standard Downsian theory, and the empirical specifications derived from it, ignore electoral turnout. Empirical evidence consistently shows that higher-income citizens are more likely to vote; office-seeking candidates should therefore include this probability in their objective function. As a consequence, the pivotal voter is not the median in the income distribution, but is generally richer. Moreover, an increase in income inequality does not unambiguously increase the political demand for redistribution, as most literature takes for granted. Including turnout in the model restores the compatibility of the Downsian theory with current empirical evidence**. A regression analysis on panel data for 41 countries in the period 1972–98 confirms the importance of turnout as an explanatory variable for social spending.**

(5) Title: Voting's rewards: Voter turnout, attentive publics, and congressional allocation of federal money.
Author: Martin, P. S. (2003).
Source: *American Journal of Political Science*, *47*(1), 110-127.
Scholars have had limited success empirically demonstrating the importance of political participation. ***This study shows that political participation matters because it influences political rewards****. Political participation, specifically voting, acts as a political resource for geographic groups. Voting is a resource because members of Congress seek to maximize the benefits of Federal budget allocations going to their districts. Members of Congress not only try to direct resources into their districts, but they also attempt to allocate strategically those resources to the areas that provide the best return in terms of votes. Hence, areas within congressional districts that vote at higher rates will be privileged over areas that vote at lower rates.*

(6) Title: "*The economic effects of democratic participation*,"
Author: Mueller, Dennis, and Thomas Stratmann, (2003)
Source: *Journal of Public Economics,* Vol. 87, Nos. 9–10, pp. 2129–2155.
Considerable concern has been expressed in recent years about declines in voter participation rates in the United States and in several other major democratic countries. Some feel low participation rates introduce a 'class bias' into the political process and thereby worsen the outcomes from it. Little empirical work exists, however, that measures the effects of lower participation on the welfare of a country. This paper begins to fill this void. It presents cross-national evidence that high levels of democratic participation are associated with more equal distributions of income. The paper's results also imply, however, that this reduction in income inequality comes at a cost. High participation rates are related to larger government sectors which in turn lead to slower economic growth. We also present evidence of the 'capture' of government by upper income groups in Latin and Central American countries.

Comment: The study is cross-national so it is likely that the variance in turnout could be attributed to structural variation, in which case the study would belong in cell IV. The study was included in this cell however because the authors included country fixed effects. The article was coded as finding a "zero effect" despite what the abstract says because the authors conclude that voter participation rates did not have a significant effect on total

state transfers or educational expenditures among a majority of the countries in their sample.

Cell IV.

(1) Title: **"Macroeconomic conditions, voter turnout, and the working-class/economically disadvantaged party vote in developing countries."**
Authors: Aguilar, Edwin Eloy, and Alexander C. Pacek.
Source: *Comparative Political Studies* 33.8 (2000): 995-1017.
Working and lower status citizens are more sensitive to macroeconomic fluctuations than their better-off counterparts in the developing world, due to the higher personal stakes involved. This heightened sensitivity affects fluctuations in voter turnout and voter choice across developing democracies. Macroeconomic downturns result in increased voter participation as more lower status voters express their grievances at the polls. This benefits political parties and coalitions with expressly working- and lower-class appeals. This article describes the impact of shifts in voter turnout on party support, the impact of macroeconomic shifts on voter turnout, and the impact of macroeconomic shifts on support for parties that are working-class/economically disadvantaged oriented using regression analysis of aggregate pooled time-series data from 10 countries in Latin America, the Caribbean, Africa, and Asia. *Although* ***increased turnout primarily helps parties that are working-class/economically disadvantaged oriented***, as is the case in the industrial world, the economic effect on party support is substantially greater.

(2) Title: "Electoral Participation, Ideology, and Party Politics in Post-Communist Europe."
Author: Bohrer, Pacek, Radcliff
Source: *Journal of Politics* 62.4 (2000): 1161-1172.
The relationship between voter participation and party fortunes has received much attention in the voting behavior literature. Specifically, a number of studies on the advanced industrial democracies postulate that left-of-center parties benefit from higher turnout. This article extends that argument to a quite different context: the economically and politically volatile post-communist world. Using aggregate data from 15 post-communist countries between 1990 and 1999, we test the turnout-party vote linkage. **We find that, indeed, increased turnout benefits left parties**, particularly the successor communist parties, while adversely affecting conservative and nationalist parties.

(3) Title: "A propensity score reweighting approach to estimating the partisan effects of full turnout in American presidential elections."
Authors: Brunell, Thomas L., and John DiNardo.
Source: *Political Analysis* 12.1 (2004): 28-45.
Abstract: Borrowing an approach from the literature on the economics of discrimination, we estimate the impact of nonvoters on the outcome of presidential elections from 1952–2000 using data from the National Election Study (NES). Our estimates indicate that nonvoters are, on average, slightly more likely to support the Democratic Party. **Of the 13 presidential elections between 1952 and 2000 we find no change in the eventual outcome of the election with two possible exceptions: 1980 and 2000**. Thus our results are not all that dissimilar from other research on participation. Higher turnout in the form of compulsory voting would not radically change the partisan distribution of the vote. When elections are sufficiently close, however, a two percentage point increase may suffice to affect the outcome. Limitations of the NES data we use suggest that our estimates underestimate the impact of nonparticipation. We also compare our method with other econometric techniques. Finally, using our findings we speculate as to why the Democratic Party fails to undertake widespread “get out the vote” or registration drives.

(4) Title: *What If Everyone Voted? Simulating the Impact of Increased Turnout in Senate Elections*
Author(s): Jack Citrin; Eric Schickler; John Sides
Source: American Journal of Political Science, Vol. 47, No. 1 (Jan., 2003), pp. 75-90
Publisher(s): Midwest Political Science Association
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/3186094
Abstract: The conventional wisdom among journalists and politicians is that higher turnout would benefit Democrats, although extant scholarly research suggests otherwise. We adopt a new approach to assessing the partisan impact of higher turnout. We use state-level exit polls and Census data to estimate the partisan preferences of nonvoters in Senate elections and then simulate the outcome of these elections under universal turnout. While nonvoters are generally more Democratic than voters, **the dearth of close races means that very few election outcomes would have changed had everyone voted**. Other scenarios-full turnout among registered voters, equal turnout rates for whites and African-Americans, and equal turnout rates across income groups-generate similar results: although Democrats fare better in each scenario, few outcomes would have changed. However, the gap between voters and nonvoters' partisan preference varies considerably across states and across years, suggesting that this "partisan differential" warrants further examination.

(5) Title: "Turnout and the Vote: The Joke's on the Democrats."
Author: DeNardo, James (1980).
Source: *American Political Science Review* 74 (2): 406–20.
A heavy turnout is commonly believed to favor the Democrats This study presents theoretical reasoning and empirical evidence that challenge the conventional view. Reasonable assumptions about the behavior of core and peripheral voters lead to the conclusion that the majority party is most likely to suffer when turnout increases, common sense notwithstanding. It also appears that **the recent decay of partisan loyalties among voters has eroded the relationship between turnout and the vote**.

(6) Title: "State Turnout and Presidential Voting: A Closer Look."
Author: Erikson, Robert (1995).
Source: *American Politics Quarterly* 23(4): 387– 96.
This article challenges Radcliff's recent claim that state-level voter turnout strongly influences state-level vote divisions for president. It is demonstrated that Radcliff's claim is an artifact of ignoring the contribution of the Voting Rights Act to southern electoral politics. **When the analysis is restricted to nonsouthern states, least squares dummy variable (LSDV) pooled time-series cross-sectional analysis shows no evidence whatsoever of a turnout effect on the vote**.

(7) Title: (Change in) turnout and (change in) the left share of the vote
Author: S.D. Fisher
Source: Electoral Studies 26 (2007), pp. 598-611
Abstract: This paper assesses the relationships between turnout and the left share of the vote, and between change in turnout and change in the left share for three data sets: national elections in 23 OECD countries 1960–2002; European Parliament elections; and British constituencies 1955–2001. **The idea that higher turnout benefits the left seems to be largely mythical. There is a positive correlation between turnout and the left share in national elections across countries, but it is likely to be the result of both variables declining independently rather than a causal connection.** There has also been a positive correlation between change in turnout and change in the left share of the vote in British constituencies since 1983, but only where Labour started first or second and so partly for strategic reasons.
Comment: This study contains three tests, each of which employs unit fixed effects: (1) Cross-national comparison of 23 OECD countries, (2) European parliament elections, and (3) British constituency elections.

(8) Title: *The Republicans Should Pray for Rain: Weather, Turnout, and Voting in U.S.*

Presidential Elections
Author(s): Brad T. Gomez; Thomas G. Hansford; George A. Krause
Source: The Journal of Politics, Vol. 69, No. 3 (Aug., 2007), pp. 649-663
Publisher(s): Cambridge University Press on behalf of the Southern Political Science Association
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/4622570
Abstract: The relationship between bad weather and lower levels of voter turnout is widely espoused by media, political practitioners, and, perhaps, even political scientists. Yet, there is virtually no solid empirical evidence linking weather to voter participation. This paper provides an extensive test of the claim. We examine the effect of weather on voter turnout in 14 U.S. presidential elections. Using GIS interpolations, we employ meteorological data drawn from over 22,000 U.S. weather stations to provide election day estimates of rain and snow for each U.S. county. We find that, when compared to normal conditions, rain significantly reduces voter participation by a rate of just less than 1% per inch, while an inch of snowfall decreases turnout by almost .5%. **Poor weather is also shown to benefit the Republican party's vote share. Indeed, the weather may have contributed to two Electoral College outcomes, the 1960 and 2000 presidential elections.**

(9) Title: ***Estimating the Electoral Effects of Voter Turnout***
Author(s): THOMAS G. HANSFORD; BRAD T. GOMEZ
Source: The American Political Science Review, Vol. 104, No. 2 (May 2010), pp. 268-288
Publisher(s): American Political Science Association
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/40863720
Abstract: This article examines the electoral consequences of variation in voter turnout in the United States. Existing scholarship focuses on the claim that high turnout benefits Democrats, but evidence supporting this conjecture is variable and controversial Previous work, however, does not account for endogeneity between turnout and electoral choice, and thus, causal claims are questionable. Using election day rainfall as an instrumental variable for voter turnout, we are able to estimate the effect of variation in turnout due to across-the-board changes in the utility of voting. We re-examine the Partisan Effects and Two-Effects Hypotheses, provide an empirical test of an Anti-Incumbent Hypothesis, and propose a Volatility Hypothesis, which posits that high turnout produces less predictable electoral outcomes. Using county-level data from the 1948-2000 presidential elections, we find support for each hypothesis. Failing to address the endogeneity problem would lead researchers to incorrectly reject all but the Anti-Incumbent Hypothesis. The effect of variation in turnout on electoral outcomes appears quite meaningful**. Although election-specific factors other than turnout have the greatest influence on who wins an election, variation in turnout significantly affects vote shares at the county, national, and Electoral College levels**.

(10) "The political implications of higher turnout."
Authors: Highton, Benjamin, and Raymond E. Wolfinger.
Source: *British Journal of Political Science* 31, no. 01 (2001):
179-223.
Would election outcomes and the substance of public policy in the United States change dramatically if more people voted? Contrary to the expectations of many others, we have found that universal turnout would bring modest changes. Two approaches lead to this conclusion. First, when the stated preferences of non-voters are aggregated with those of voters, little change is observed. Secondly, to address the possibility that non-voters' preferences would be different if they were mobilized to vote, we attributed the preferences of voters to cognate non-voters and again aggregated the two groups. This approach provided even smaller estimates of change. In other words, by addressing Lijphart's critique of the first method, we found less support for the conventional wisdom that higher turnout would be a boon for the Democrats. The explanation for the modest changes may be found in the characteristics of non-voters. To be sure, the poor, less educated and minorities are overrepresented among non-voters. But the young and the transient are even more numerous. By themselves, none of these groups constitutes even a majority of non-voters. Combined, they barely do so. What our findings have demonstrated is that the 'party of non-voters' is heterogeneous.

(11) Title "Does rain help the Republicans? Theory and evidence on turnout and the vote."
Author: Knack, Steve.
Public Choice 79.1-2 (1994): 187-209.
Abstract. Conventional political wisdom holds that inclement weather on election day reduces turnout, and helps elect Republican candidates. Analysis of National Climatic Data Center weather records and National Election Studies (NES) survey data for 1984, 1986, and 1988 refutes the latter hypothesis: interaction variables based on various measures of partisanship and election day rainfall show no evidence of partisan differences in the turnout-deterring impact of inclement weather. Furthermore, rainfall does not significantly reduce the probability of voting for the NES samples as a whole, but only among those respondents scoring low on the standard NES civic duty indicator.

(12) Title: *Partisan Effects of Voter Turnout in Korean Elections, 1992–2010*
Author(s): Junhan Lee; Wonjae Hwang
Source: Asian Survey, Vol. 52, No. 6 (November/December 2012), pp. 1161-1182
Publisher(s): University of California Press
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/10.1525/as.2012.52.6.1161
Abstract: Abstract This paper explores the partisan effects of voter turnout in 12 Korean elections. We argue theoretically and **show empirically that hypothetical increases in turnout generate benefits for left-wing or minor parties, rather than right-wing or major parties. Complete voter turnout may have changed the actual electoral results in close elections.**

(13) Title: "Low turnout in direct democracy."
Author: Lutz, Georg.
Source: *Electoral Studies* 26.3 (2007): 624-632.
Direct democracy in Switzerland provides a particularly valuable site for the study of the direct policy consequences of low turnout. The analysis of the outcomes of 144 popular votes between 1981 and 1999 shows that the level of information held by voters matters slightly more for the outcome of a popular vote than does the level of turnout, controlling for the levels of information. About 35 percent of votes would have had a different approval rate if all citizens had voted, but even more results would have changed had voters had been much better informed. **Counter to the conventional wisdom, in those cases where turnout and information did matter higher levels of turnout tended to work in favour of right-wing parties, whereas higher levels of information tended to work to favour outcomes supported by left-wing parties.** Further, the findings suggest that the outcomes of popular votes are most likely to be biased when voters think an issue is unimportant and both levels of turnout and information are low.
Comment: Lutz finds that higher turnout actually helped right-wing shares.

(14) Title: *The Effects of Turnout on Partisan Outcomes in U.S. Presidential Elections 1960-2000*
Author(s): Michael D. Martinez; Jeff Gill
Source: The Journal of Politics, Vol. 67, No. 4 (Nov., 2005), pp. 1248-1274
Publisher(s): Cambridge University Press on behalf of the Southern Political Science Association
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/3449904
Abstract: It is commonly believed by pundits and political elites that higher turnout favors Democratic candidates, but the extant research is inconsistent in finding this effect. The purpose of this article is to provide scholars with a methodology for assessing the likely effects of turnout on an election outcome using simulations based on survey data. **By varying simulated turnout rates for five U.S. elections from 1960 to 2000, we observe that Democratic advantages from higher turnout (and Republican advantages from lower turnout) have steadily ebbed since 1960, corresponding to the erosion of class cleavages in U.S. elections**.

(15) Title: *Does Turnout Decline Matter? Electoral Turnout and Partisan Choice in the 1997*
Author(s): Michael D. Martinez and Jeff Gill
Source: Canadian Journal of Political Science / Revue canadienne de science politique, Vol. 39,
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/25165955

Abstract: The recent decline in electoral turnout in Canada has attracted the concern of scholars and public officials, but the partisan consequences of this decline have received only scant attention. We begin to address that question with a simulation based on the 1997 Canadian Election Study. **Based on estimated probabilities of individual behaviour derived from multinomial logit models of voter choice, we find that higher turnout would have likely hurt the Liberal party in Quebec, but slightly helped the Liberals outside of Quebec**. We interpret this pattern as evidence that generational politics plays a role in shaping the relationship between electoral turnout and partisan support.

(16) Title: "Differential turnout and party advantage in British general elections, 1964–83."
Authors: McAllister, Ian, and Anthony Mughan.
Source: *Electoral Studies* 5.2 (1986): 143-152.
Abstract: Contradictory expectations exist about the effect of differential turnout on party support. This paper estimates the likely changes in party support in Britain under different levels of turnout. **By applying multivariate analysis to individual-level data collected in 1964, 1974 and 1983, we argue that there is a consistent Conservative disadvantage in higher turnout, but that the corresponding Labour advantage is either slight or non-existent. The Liberals (and the Alliance in 1983) usually make a modest gain from increased turnout.** While the magnitude of these changes in the vote may be small, they have the potential to determine the outcome of closely fought elections.
Comment: The authors' estimated effect is extremely small.

(17) Title: *Partisan Effects of Voter Turnout in Senatorial and Gubernatorial Elections*
Author(s): Jack H. Nagel; John E. McNulty
Source: The American Political Science Review, Vol. 90, No. 4 (Dec., 1996), pp. 780-793
Publisher(s): American Political Science Association
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/2945842
Abstract: Conventional wisdom holds that higher turnout favors Democrats. Previous studies of this hypothesis rely on presidential and House elections or on survey data, but senatorial and gubernatorial elections offer better conditions for directly testing turnout effects in U.S. politics. In a comprehensive analysis of these statewide elections since 1928, **we find that the conventional theory was true outside the South through 1964, but since 1965 the overall relationship between turnout and partisan outcomes has been insignificant.** Even before the mid-1960s, the turnout effect outside the South was strongest in Republican states and insignificant or negative in heavily Democratic states. A similar but weaker pattern obtains after 1964. In the South, which we analyze only since 1966, higher turnout helped Republicans until 1990, but in 1990-94 the effect became pro-Democratic. The conventional theory cannot account for these complex patterns, but they are impressively consistent with DeNardo's (1980) theory.

(18) Voter turnout in New Zealand general elections, 1928-1988.
Author: Nagel, J. H. (1988).
Source *Political Science*, *40*(2), 16-38.

(19) Title: "Turnout and the vote for left-of-centre parties: a cross-national analysis."
Authors: Pacek, Alexander, and Benjamin Radcliff.
Source *British Journal of Political Science*25.01 (1995): 137-143.
Our analysis suggests a number of implications. The most obvious is that **the electoral fate of the left is affected by the rate of turnout,** with the magnitude of this relationship depending on the degree to which such parties do in fact depend upon the votes of working-class and economically disadvantaged citizens. Thus, while even nominally 'left' parties such as the Democrats in the United States have a stake in fostering higher turnout, other more traditional left parties, such as Labour in the United Kingdom or the SDP in Germany, have even greater incentives to do so.

(20) Title: *Voter Participation and Party-Group Fortunes in European Parliament Elections, 1979-1999: A Cross-National Analysis*
Author(s): Alexander C. Pacek; Benjamin Radcliff
Source: Political Research Quarterly, Vol. 56, No. 1 (Mar., 2003), pp. 91-95
Publisher(s): Sage Publications, Inc. on behalf of the University of Utah
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/3219887
Abstract: Scholars have addressed the relationship between voter participation and party electoral fortunes for some time. Specifically, a number of studies postulate that left-of-center parties are the primary beneficiaries of higher rates of voter turnout. This research note extends this argument to a classic "low turnout" environment: the elections to the European Parliament. Using data from 11 members of the European Union between 1979 and 1999, we test the turnout-party vote linkage through pooled cross-national time series analysis. **We find that, indeed, increased turnout benefits the left party groups in the European Parliament.** We conclude with some implications for this finding.

(21) Title: "Turnout and the Democratic Vote."
Author: Radcliff, Benjamin. (1994).
Source: *American Politics Quarterly* 22(July): 259-76.
Although political folk wisdom has long suggested that high turnout works to the advantage of the Democratic Party, this hypothesis has not fared well when subjected to empirical testing. **The author finds strong and unequivocal evidence in support of the conventional view that greater turnout does profit Democratic candidates.** This effect appears to have become more pronounced since 1960. The magnitude of the relationship is found to be considerable, such that even modest changes in turnout would have been sufficient to reverse the outcomes of recent presidential elections. The implications for party strategies and the study of voting are discussed.
***Comment*: The research design was improved upon and the results was effectively overturned by Erikson (1995). Radcliff (1995) subsequently published a rejoinder arguing that his original results were valid. Radcliff (1994) and Radcliff (1995) are treated as a single test in the meta-analysis rather than two independent observations.**

(22) Title: "Does low turnout matter? Evidence from the 2000 Canadian federal election"
Authors: Rubenson, D., Blais, A., Fournier, P., Gidengil, E., & Nevitte, N. (2007).
Source: *Electoral Studies*, *26*(3), 589-597.
We examine whether turnout has a partisan bias; specifically whether higher turnout would benefit parties and policies of the left. Using data from the 2000 Canadian Election Study, we analyze differences in opinion between voters and non-voters across a wide spectrum of policy areas in order to assess the extent of divergent views between voters and abstainers. Next, by simulating universal turnout we test the hypothesis that the outcome of the 2000 Canadian Federal Election would have been appreciably different if all citizens were to have voted. **We find scant evidence for a partisan effect of turnout in Canada.** Voters' opinions are, by and large, representative of the larger population and universal turnout would not have changed the election result.

(23) Title: Do Labour Parties Suffer from Declining Turnout? Evidence from Norwegian Local Elections

Authos: Saglie, Jo, Johannes Bergh, and Tor Bjorklund
Source: *Local Government Studies* 38.2 (2012): 249-270.
The argument that declining voter turnout harms social democratic parties has received little support in research on national elections, but partisan consequences of declining turnout in local elections has been less explored. Norwegian local elections – where both turnout and support for the Labour Party have declined since the early 1960s – are used as a test case. **Analyses of aggregate data gave no systematic support for the hypothesis that Labour suffers from lower turnout.** Declining turnout and declining Labour Party vote were not causally related, and the correlation between the two variables seemed to be the result of other long-term social

changes. Analyses of survey data pointed to three flaws in the premises on which the hypothesis was based. First, the effect of declining turnout on the biased class composition of the abstainers was ambiguous. Second, the Norwegian Labour Party suffers less from differential turnout than before as a result of declining class voting. Third, the Labour Party may suffer from a demobilisation of the working class, but the party may also benefit from a demobilisation of the young.

(24) Title: **"If Everyone Had Voted, Would Bubba and Dubya Have Won?"**
Authors: Sides, John, Eric Schickler, and Jack Citrin.
Source: *Presidential Studies Quarterly* 38.3 (2008): 521-539.
Adapting and refining the approach used in earlier work on Senate elections, we simulate the impact of universal turnout on each presidential election from 1992 to 2004 and find little evidence that increased turnout would systematically transform partisan competition or policy outcomes. A state-level analysis of exit polls and the Current Population Survey reveals considerable variability in the gap separating voters and nonvoters. In most cases, nonvoters are just slightly more Democratic than voters. However, a handful of states, such as Texas, consistently feature a large "partisan differential," in which nonvoters come disproportionately from demographic groups that are more Democratic than voters. We find that universal turnout may well have tipped an extremely close election—such as that of 2000 or even 2004—into the Democratic column. But **the partisan differential is generally small enough that universal turnout would only change the outcome of an already close contest rather than leading to a wholesale transformation of competitive dynamics.**

(25) Title: ***Inequalities of Political Influence in New Democracies***
Author(s): Gábor Tóka; Marina Popescu
Source: International Journal of Sociology, Vol. 37, No. 4, Causes and Consequences of Political Inequality in Cross-National Perspective (Winter, 2007/2008), pp. 67-93
Publisher(s): M.E. Sharpe, Inc.
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/20628312
Abstract: We examine two sources of political inequalities that seem inevitable in elections, supposedly the most egalitarian and most fundamental of modern democratic processes. The first stems from the fact that not everyone is equally likely to vote, and the second from unequal political information levels, which may make some groups of citizens better able than others to express their political preferences in the vote. We use survey data from two economically less advanced new democracies to empirically assess the degree to which inequalities of turnout and political information level may influence election outcomes. Our statistical analysis relies on simulation methods developed by Bartels (1996) and Citrin, Schickler, and Sides (2003). For the first time in the literature, we provide separate estimates of how equally large increases in everyone's knowledge and how a complete equalization of knowledge level across social groups may affect election outcomes. Our results show that election outcomes in Romania and Moldova may be a little different if citizens were much better informed. However, ***we find no change in the outcomes as a result of an equalization of turnout* and information level across social groups.** Thus, elections in the two countries aggregate citizen preferences probably imperfectly, but in a definitely egalitarian way.

(26) Title: "**Does Heavy Turnout Help Democrats in Presidential Elections?"**
Authors: Tucker, Harvey J., and Arnold Vedlitz. (1986).
Source: *American Political Science Review*, 87(4): 1291–98.
The conventional model is unacceptable as a comprehensive description of patterns of turnout and partisan advantage in presidential elections. Yet it appears to be a plausible model to guide election strategy for state and national party officials. However one defines turnout and partisan advantage, **Democratic presidential candidates have been unquestionably advantaged by high turnout in a number of states typically viewed as keys to Democratic victory**. High turnout is strongly related to Democratic success in states such as Illinois, California, Pennsylvania, Connecticut, and New Jersey. In this narrower strategic sense, the conventional model has been consistently valid since 1932. High turnout alone cannot guarantee Democratic

victories in state or national election contests. Nevertheless, there are good reasons for the Democratic party to work for high turnout in a minority of targeted states and in the nation as a whole.